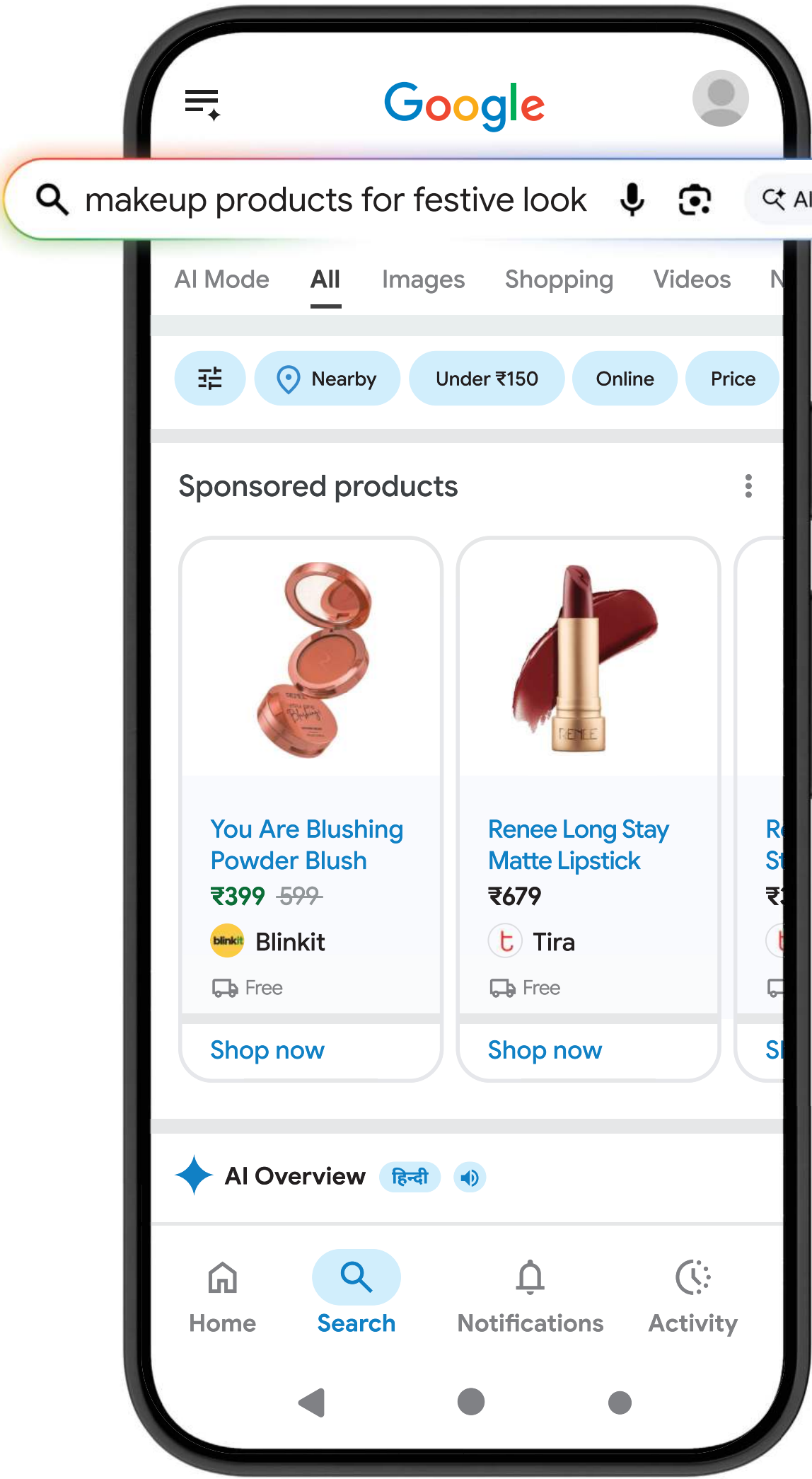




Modaks, New Looks & Festive Decor

Turn every festive Search into business growth



RENÉE

Reached more shoppers, driving 11.5% incremental sales with Commerce Media Suite

tira

Leveraged AI Max to expand its reach on Google Search and grew purchases by 35%



Supercharge decision-making this festive season



*Some elements edited or created with AI

Drive festive business growth



87%

of **Google AI Overview** or **AI Mode** users in India agree they're able to make more confident decisions because of them¹



1.47x

Google Search ROI was 1.47x of Total Media ROI²



Supercharge decision-making
this festive season



Sources: 1. Google commissioned Ipsos Global Consumer Journeys, Dec 2025
2. Commissioned Analytic Edge MMM Meta Analysis 2021-2025

*Some elements edited or created with AI

PROVIDING MEASURABLE OUTCOMES

Varaha Bullish on Carbon Credit Mkt

 Varaha, which works with smallholder farmers on carbon removal projects, sees growing opportunity in India's nascent carbon market, even as the demand for its carbon credits currently comes from global companies, reports **Ayanti Bera**. Varaha is the winner in the Social Enterprise category at The Economic Times Startup Awards 2026. >>> 11

UNDER FTA AND MFN

India Set to Get 1.64 mt EU Steel Exports Quota

India will get country-specific tariff rate quotas of 1.64 million tonnes annually to export steel products to the European Union, of which 694,853 tonnes will be under the free trade agreement, and the rest under the most favoured nation component. >>> 7

Banks Seek RBI Nod to Use New Rules for Old Trade Mismatches

Banks have sought regulatory clearance to close unsettled cross-border client trades that have touched almost ₹1 lakh crore over the years, with many even pending for a decade. They want RBI's nod for using new rules taking effect October 1, to close millions of unreconciled exports-imports. **Sugata Ghosh** reports. >>> 12

Voda Idea Seeks ₹35kcr Loan to Meet Next Decade's Capex Needs

Vodafone Idea (Vi) is stitching together a consortium of eight to ten lenders to finance a ₹35,000-crore, 10-year term loan as the Aditya Birla Group-backed telecom operator gets set to raise funds for capital expenditure in the next decade. SBI is likely to take ₹7,000-crore exposure. **Joel Rebello & Himanshi Lohchab** report. >>> 12

Bharucha, an Outsider's Name Sent to RBI for CEO Job at HDFC Bank

HDFC Bank has named deputy MD Kaizad Bharucha and one external candidate to RBI for its top job. ICICI Pru Life CEO Anup Bagchi and Citi India CEO K Balasubramanian were among short-listed outsiders. **Saloni Shukla** reports. >>> 10

PURE POLITICS

Significant Cut in PLA's LAC Deployment Last Year: Defence Ministry

 A significant reduction in deployment of Chinese troops along the LAC was witnessed in 2025, with 10 combined arms brigades deployed along the northern borders, the defence ministry's annual report said. **Manu Pubby** reports. >>> 3

Along Arunachal's Frontier Highway, Infra is in Focus >>> 3

Trinamool Overpaid for Carewell Plane Use, Shows ED Probe

 Trinamool Congress paid substantially more per flying hour for a Carewell Aviation plane – around 2.15 times – than the average rate charged by the company, according to details from ED's investigation, reports **Raghav Ohri**. >>> 3

The offices of The Economic Times will remain closed today on the occasion of Ganesh Chaturthi. Hence, there will be no edition of the newspaper on Tuesday, 15th September 2026.

F&B Cos Rush to Revise Recipes ahead of Warning Labels

Brands don't want to wait for final verdict on FSSAI's front-of-pack label norms since R&D on reformulations will take a long time

Ratna Bhushan

New Delhi: Food and beverages makers are rushing to reduce sugar, salt and saturated fats in their cookies, noodles, snacks, soft drinks and frozen foods, well before the government's final verdict on front-of-pack labelling kicks in, executives at large companies said. Alongside, multiple multinationals are, for the first time, reducing salt and sugar ahead of deadlines mandated by their global headquarters, fearing a decline in sales once the red hexagonal warnings proposed by the Food Safety & Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) become mandatory. "No one is waiting for the final verdict, as it's just a matter of time

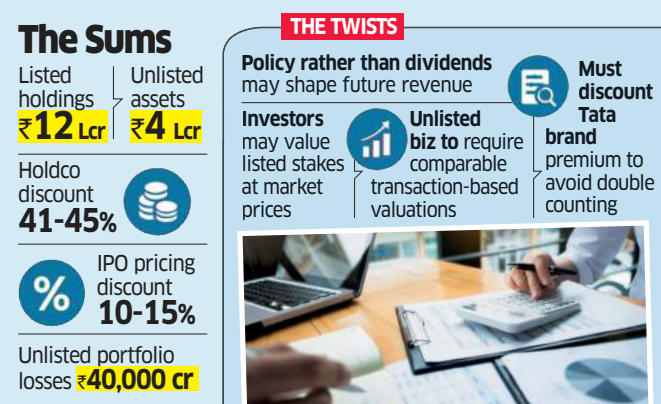
Tata Sons may be Valued up to ₹12.5Lcr in Potential IPO

Calculations put group holding co's underlying portfolio at ₹15-16 lakh crore

Sagar Malviya, Reghu Balakrishnan & Shilpy Sinha

Mumbai: Tata Sons could be valued at ₹9-12.5 lakh crore in a potential initial public offering (IPO), multiple investment bankers and valuation experts told ET, putting a steep discount on an underlying portfolio worth ₹15-16 lakh crore. Valuations will hinge on how investors price its listed stakes and unlisted businesses, while assigning the traditional discount to a typical holding company structure.

An analysis by the equity capital markets head of a top domestic bank puts Tata Sons' underlying value at ₹15-16 lakh crore, comprising about ₹12 lakh crore from lis-



OTHER NEWS OF THE DAY

Bengal Police Summons Cong Leader

KOLKATA: West Bengal Congress general secretary Ashutosh Chatterjee on Sunday said he was summoned by the police over alleged burning of a photograph of Dhirendra Krishna Shastri, popularly known as Bageshwar Baba, during a protest over the preacher's comments regarding Durga Puja. In a statement, Chatterjee said a notice from the Bhawanipur police station was served on him around 10 am, directing him to appear before the investigating officer in the case. He said state Congress president Subhankar Sarkar had been informed about the development. The case relates to a September 8 demonstration outside the Bhawanipur police station in south Kolkata over remarks made by Shastri about Bengalis, Bengal's culture and food practices during Durga Puja. During the protest, a photograph of Shastri was allegedly trampled upon, struck with footwear and burnt, police said. **Police subsequently arrested South Kolkata district Congress general secretary Atanu Das.**

Firing at Punjabi Singer Sidhu's Barnala House

CHANDIGARH: Three unidentified motor-cycle-borne men allegedly opened fire at the residence of Punjabi singer Gulab Sidhu in Punjab's Barnala district, police said on Sunday, adding that nobody was hurt in the incident. Sidhu was not present in the house when the alleged incident took place. However, **his family members were present.** The incident occurred late Saturday night when three masked men arrived on the motorcycle and opened fire towards the gate of Sidhu's residence in village Pharwahi in Barnala district. One of the assailants, who was driving the motorcycle, **appeared to be making a video with a mobile phone,** while two others opened fire. The entire incident was captured on a CCTV camera, which went viral on social media. Bullets hit the main gate of the house. —PTI

Poliloquy R PRASAD



A peace offensive! Stopping just short of the Nehruvian line: 'Hindi-Chini bhai bhai.'

Delhi Declaration Backs Sovereign Palestinian State

Seeks East Jerusalem as its capital, expresses concern over continued violence in Gaza, opposes forced displacement of Palestinians

Dipanjnan Roy Chaudhury

New Delhi: The situation in Gaza, status of Palestine and ICJ proceedings against Israel found prominent mention in the Delhi Declaration adopted by the BRICS members at their 18th summit here. BRICS leaders expressed concern over continued violence in Gaza, opposed forced displacement of Palestinians and supported a sovereign Palestinian state within the 1967 borders, with East Jerusalem as its capital. The declaration rejected any unilateral measures seeking to alter the legal and historical status of occupied Jerusalem. The declaration also referred to proceedings brought by South Africa



International Court of Justice proceedings against Israel mentioned prominently

against Israel at the International Court of Justice (ICJ) and noted Israel's "legal obligation to ensure the provision of humanitarian aid in Gaza". "We take note of the adoption of UNSC Resolution 2803. We call for the implementation of the relevant UNGA and UNSC resolutions and urge all parties to ensure the maintenance of ceasefire and full and unhindered humanitarian access in the Gaza Strip. In this context, we express deep concern on the continued violence in Gaza despite the ceasefire agreement of Oc-



Any unilateral step seeking to alter legal and historical status of occupied Jerusalem rejected

tober 2025. We call for halting any policies aimed at forced displacement of Palestinians from Gaza Strip and express concern regarding arrangements that may prejudice the inalienable rights of the Palestinian people and legitimise or prolong occupation," the declaration noted. BRICS reaffirmed that a just and lasting solution to the Israeli-Palestinian conflict can only be achieved by peaceful means and depends on the fulfilment of the legitimate rights of the Palestinian people, including the

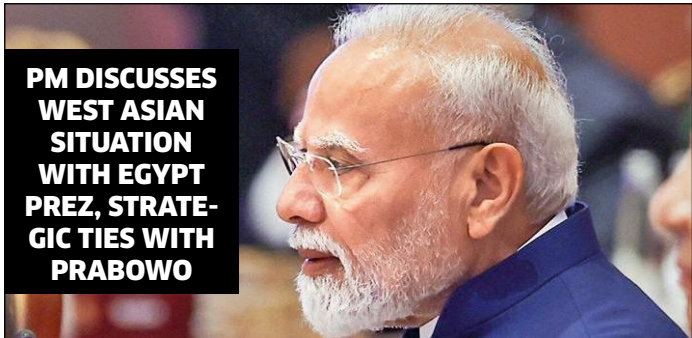


BRICS members oppose forced displacement of any of the Palestinian population

rights to self-determination and return. BRICS member states expressed firm opposition to the forced displacement, temporary or permanent, under any pretext, of any of the Palestinian population from the Occupied Palestinian Territory, as well as any geographic or demographic changes to the territory of the Gaza Strip. The group reiterated grave concern about the situation in the Occupied Palestinian Territory, including the humanitarian situation in Gaza.

ON THE SIDELINES OF THE SUMMIT

Modi, Kazakh Prez Discuss EAEU FTA & Critical Minerals



PM DISCUSSES WEST ASIAN SITUATION WITH EGYPT PREZ, STRATEGIC TIES WITH PRABOWO

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday met with Kazakhstan President Kassym-Jomart Tokayev on the sidelines of the 18th BRICS summit in New Delhi and discussed expanding partnership in the areas of critical minerals and emerging technologies. India's proposed free trade agreement with Eurasian Economic Union (EAEU) was also discussed. As the current chair of EAEU, Kazakhstan is advancing work towards an FTA with India, Tokayev informed Modi. EAEU comprises Armenia, Belarus, Kazakhstan, the Kyrgyz Republic and Russia. India and the grouping signed the terms of reference for the proposed FTA in Moscow in August 2025. Kazakhstan is a BRICS partner country. Modi also met Egyptian President Abdel Fattah El-Sisi. In a post on social media, the PM said the two leaders discussed a range of issues, including key regional developments and the steadily growing friendship. Egypt is a key pillar of the Arab world and did not join the Mecca Pact despite being encouraged by Turkey and Pakistan.

The PM also met the Indonesian President, two months after his trip to Jakarta that elevated their ties. "Lovely catching up with President Prabowo Subianto... His warmth, positivity and spirit of optimism are always endearing. India and Indonesia will keep strengthening their partnership across a wide range of sectors," the PM wrote on social media.

Modi also met Cyril Ramaphosa, President of the Republic of South Africa, and reviewed the progress achieved in diverse areas of cooperation and exchanged views on the multi-faceted strategic partnership between India and South Africa.

The two leaders exchanged views on a range of global issues and agreed to maintain close coordination in multilateral fora. In the context of the successful translocation of cheetahs from South Africa to India, the prime minister invited South Africa to consider joining the International Big Cat Alliance.



VIA AI EXCELLENCE

Indo-Russian Hub to Deepen Tech Innovation

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: Indo-Russia 'Innopraktika' Technology Hub has signed four strategic MoUs to deepen technology, innovation and industrial ties between India and Russia.

'Innopraktika' formalised partnerships on the sidelines of the summit spanning AI in healthcare, advanced electronics manufacturing, cross-



AI CoE underscores hub's role as a vital bridge between the two nations' innovation ecosystems

border investment facilitation and a new India-Russia AI Centre of Excellence (CoE) — underscoring the hub's role as a vital bridge between the two nations' innovation ecosystems. CoE unites 'Innopraktika' with the Government of the Nizhny Novgorod Region and the RUSSOFT Software Developers Association to establish an India-Russia Centre of Excellence in AI and cybersecurity, to be hosted through 'Gorky Tech', according to Debjit Chakraborty, CEO and executive director of Indo-Russia 'Innopraktika' Technology Hub.

FOLLOWING WESTERN SANCTIONS

Putin Proposes BRICS Cover, Deal for Grain Market

Compliments functioning of New Development Bank, says it is handling projects worth \$140 b

Dipanjnan Roy Chaudhury

New Delhi: Russian President Vladimir Putin on Sunday proposed a new insurance mechanism and a collaborative initiative for the grain market among the BRICS nations.

The mechanism has been suggested in the wake of Western sanctions hindering some Russian firms' access to global insurance. Russia had introduced the framework for grain ex-

change at the BRICS trade ministers' meeting in August in Jaipur. BRICS countries contribute about 42% of the global agricultural and food output and are home to more than two-thirds of the world's small and marginal farmers. "We have independent routes for moving capital, labour and technologies. In fact, we can operate regardless of outside pressure," Putin said at a BRICS session.

"We have some promising initiatives going forward, such as creating an insurance mechanism and a grain market' change at the BRICS trade ministers' meeting in August in Jaipur. BRICS countries contribute about 42% of the global agricultural and food output and are home to more than two-thirds of the world's small and marginal farmers. "We have independent routes for moving capital, labour and technologies. In fact, we can operate regardless of outside pressure," Putin said at a BRICS session.

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Suspected Militants Gun Down Four in Two Manipur Districts

Our Political Bureau | PTI

Guwahati | Imphal: At least four people, including two women, were killed when suspected militants attacked their villages in Manipur's Tamenglong and Noney districts on Sunday, police said.

The Tamenglong incident occurred at about 4 am leaving two persons dead, while the second one that took place around 12 hours later also claimed two lives.



US envoy Sergio Gor at Loktak Lake in Manipur's Bishnupur on Sat - ANI

Mirwaiz, Others Meet Araghchi

India, with its legacy of Mahatma Gandhi's philosophy of ahimsa, could play a constructive role in encouraging peace: Mirwaiz

Hakeem Irfan Rashid

Srinagar: Kashmiri leaders Mirwaiz Umar Farooq, along with Aga Syed Hassan and Molvi Imran Raza Ansari, met Iranian foreign minister Abbas Araghchi on the sidelines of the BRICS summit in New Delhi and exchanged views on the grave situation confronting the region, the need for restraint and diplomacy, and the



importance of safeguarding unity within the Muslim Ummah. Mirwaiz said India, with its legacy of Mahatma Gandhi's philosophy of ahimsa, could play a constructive role in encouraging restraint, diplomacy and peaceful engagement at a time of growing international tensions. The delegation conveyed its solidarity with the people of Iran and expressed deep concern over the loss of innocent lives.

Congress Seeks PM's Response After his Meeting with Xi

Raises reported Chinese 'advances' in Arunachal Pradesh, asks Operation Sindoor-related question

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: Congress on Sunday said Prime Minister Narendra Modi must answer four questions since his bilateral summit with Chinese Presi-

dent Xi Jinping got over, including about reported Chinese "territorial advances" in Arunachal Pradesh and whether India softened its stand on Chinese support to Pakistan during Operation Sindoor in order to facilitate the Modi-Xi meeting.

Former external affairs minister Salman Khurshid said the government should take the Opposition into confidence about Modi-Xi talks. "What happened during the prime minister's talks with the Chinese president, what points were raised, what was China's response to them, and what path forward has been considered?" he said.

Maintaining that "normalisation of India's relations with China is one thing, but what has been in evidence on your (PM) part is calibrated capitulation."

Our traditional patrolling and grazing rights across large stretches of eastern Ladakh have been quietly but definitely surrendered... Didn't your infamous clean chit to China (after the Galwan Valley incident) weaken India?

JAIRAM RAMESH Congress Spokesman

tion", Congress spokesman Jairam Ramesh asked in an official statement, "Why have you allowed China's territorial advances in Ladakh and now Aru-

nachal Pradesh?... Our traditional patrolling and grazing rights across large stretches of eastern Ladakh have been quietly but definitely surrendered."

The party also asked whether the PM "allowed softening of India's position" on China's role in support of Pakistan during Operation Sindoor: "On August

25, 2026, the former Chief of Defence Staff Gen Anil Chauhan took a completely different position in a lecture at the VIF (Vivekananda International Foundation), with which the national security adviser has been closely associated. Was this part of a strategy to change the atmospherics leading up to yesterday's meeting?" Further, "didn't your infamous clean chit to China (after the Galwan Valley incident) on June 19, 2020, weaken India?"

Questioning India's trade deficit with China, Congress said 'Make in India' and 'Import from China' have become two sides of the same coin.

Mr Grumpyji, Zara Sach Sach Kaho...

When fufaji (husband of father's sister) is naraz (upset or angry), it isn't very challenging to handle the situation once the reasons can be identified. The causes are mostly simple: Either he hasn't been served his tea or meals on time at his in-laws' house, or someone has said something unpalatable to him. Fufa, also known as pisa or piusa in some parts of our country, is a true treasure for his ability to blend in with anyone at the in-laws' home. When he is happy, he acts as the best ambassador for the in-laws, but when he is upset and angry, he spends his time gossiping about the family with fat-

her-in-law's brothers and uncles. In either situation, he appears to be an appealing person — if he is content or pleased, it indicates that the in-laws are performing their duties exceptionally well; but if he is gossiping, it suggests that the 'naraz fufa' is seeking special attention on some matter. Whenever fufaji gossips, he is more than sure that the in-laws will get the gist of the talk. In several cases, fufaji's narazgi (displeasure) is disclosed by fufi (fufaji's wife) herself. If fufaji is a perpetually troubled soul, he is ignored, and after a while, his concerns are not taken seriously. But when chachaji (father's brother) is infuriated, it



POLIMICK



R PRASAD

turns into a bigger issue for the family. This is something that the household cannot brush aside. After all, chachajis are stakeholders in the family and are privy to the secrets too. This is why fufaji's narazgi becomes a subject of public dis-

course while chachaji's is taken seriously and attempts are made to fix it. Chachaji's anger can't just be swept under the carpet.

Pravir Kumar



PHOTO JUNCTION

Odisha Forms Panel to Look After 5 Rescued Orangutans

BHUBANESWAR: The Odisha government constituted a five-member technical committee to oversee the care of five baby orangutans rescued from Balasore district, officials said on Sunday. The baby orangutans are at present kept at the Nandankanan Zoological Park in Bhubaneswar, they said. The panel will assess issues related to the welfare and upkeep of the rescued animals and provide technical inputs for their proper care, an order said. —PTI

WITH CENTRE'S FOCUS ON INFRASTRUCTURE BUILD-UP IN BORDER AREAS

Arunachal Pradesh Frontier Highway: Clearing Hurdles on Road to 2029 Target

Lada-Sarli issue resolved, with key land acquisition complete & construction to begin soon

Anubhuti Vishnoi

New Delhi: BRICS diplomacy aside, the Centre is focussed on infrastructure build-up in border areas from Ladakh to Arunachal Pradesh with the latter's Frontier Highways on high priority.

After several hiccups from rows over land acquisition to multi-core compensation scams and suspension of senior officials, the strategic 1,824-km-long Arunachal Frontier Highway (NH 913) along the McMahon Line is finally on track with the Centre clearing almost all hurdles and readying for significant construction activity days from now, officials in the know told ET.

A major pain point now stands largely resolved — the 125-km Lada to Sarli high-altitude highway alignment in East Kameng district, sources said. This segment ran into serious controversy over land acquisition, compensation computation and allegations of siphoning of funds, delaying the



project and drawing in the Anti-Corruption Bureau to finally an inter-ministerial committee.

A key central intervention followed involving an administrative revamp and setting up of an independent new ground verification committee manned by officials from other districts to re-assess the compensation entitlement.

The result: The final compensation outgo came down from nearly ₹250 crore to ₹185 crore. It is learnt to have been accepted, clearing the way for full land acquisition which has now been done, officials in the know told ET. The Ministry of Road Transport & Highways

(MORTH) has moved fast with a private firm recently winning the tender to get moving on Lada-Sarli.

There is, however, more to ensuring that the crucial frontier highway stays firmly on track. Conceptualised in 2016, the project to link Bomdila in West Kameng district to Vijaynagar in Changlang district along the Indo-Bhutan and Indo-Myanmar borders, has been progressing slowly amid challenges apart from serious terrain and logistical constraints. The Centre is looking at a 2029 deadline for project completion, and several gear shifts are aimed at achieving that.

If Lada-Sarli is an example, the second is how packages under the ambitious project are now gradually being shifted to the National Highways & Infrastructure Development Corporation Ltd (NHIDCL) and Border Roads Organisation (BRO), minimising state PWD role after the land compensation episode. The idea is to ensure uniform road quality along the two-lane highway and minimise undesirable interferences which may impact project pace, officials in the know held. There is also the

debatable forest clearance issue for the highway that is to run deep through the forests.

The state government, on the back of the Forest Conservation Amendment Act of 2023 which exempted strategic linear projects within 100 km of the Line of Control (LoC) and Line of Actual Control (LAC) from prior central clearance, is learnt to have granted forest clearance to the Frontier highway within a week's time, as per those in the know.

The National Board of Wildlife (NBWL) also granted permission in 2025 for diversion of 310 hectares of forest land from Namdapha tiger reserve for the highway, citing strategic interests.

With segments of the Frontier Highway running parallel to China's G 219 (Xinjiang-Tibet highway), and as close as 20 km to the LAC, it is, in fact, a strategic interest that is central to the project.

India, through NH 913, seeks to build strategic capability and connectivity in an area with high infrastructure buildup on the Chinese side. The project is key to enabling rapid movement of defence forces through Arunachal Pradesh.

It will also supplement and link up with the existing Trans-Arunachal Highways and the Arunachal East-West corridor in the southern part of the state with six vertical and diagonal national highway corridors envisaged to ensure all-round connectivity to the state and its north-eastern neighbours.



Project packages gradually being shifted to NHIDCL & BRO, reducing role of state PWD after compensation-related row

₹15L Aid for Ladakh Victims' Families

Srinagar: Ladakh LG Vinai Kumar Saxena on Sunday announced a compensation of ₹15 lakh to the next of kin of those killed in the September 24 violence last year and ₹3 lakh for those who sustained major injuries. "In our continued commitment to support the families affected by the tragic violence in Ladakh on 24 September last year, today sanctioned a compensation of ₹15 lakh to the next of kin of each of the four deceased," Saxena said. — **Hakeem Irfan Rashid**

NO MENTION OF INDIAN TROOP DEPLOYMENTS SPECIFICALLY

PLA Troop Deployment Along LAC Saw Significant Decline in 2025: MoD Report

STRETCHING FROM LADAKH TO ARUNACHAL Roughly 45,000-50,000 Chinese troops at Line of Actual Control

Manu Pubby

New Delhi: There was a significant reduction in deployment of Chinese troops along the Line of Actual Control (LAC) in 2025, with 10 combined arms brigades deployed along the northern borders, the annual report of the Ministry of Defence (MoD) has stated.

The report, which covers FY2025-26, says the People's Liberation Army has an additional 10 brigades deployed in its traditional training areas. While the report has been released this month, it is dated before the current round of border tensions in Arunachal Pradesh, which has also led to forward deployment of additional troops. "The year 2025 witnessed significant reduction in deployment of People's Liberation Army (PLA) Forces opposite Northern Borders, with 10 Combined Arms Brigade size forces



An Army soldier guarding an Indian post at the Indo-China border area in Bumla, Arunachal Pradesh.

each deployed in areas along the LAC and in traditional training areas," it says. This would translate to about 45,000-50,000 Chinese troops along the LAC that stretches from Ladakh to Arunachal Pradesh, with an equal number at traditional training areas. During the 2020 border crisis, almost 60,000 Chinese troops were de-

ployed along the Ladakh border. The report does not mention Indian deployments. The annual report does not specifically mention the situation in Arunachal but says that deployment of Indian Army in "all sectors along LAC is robust, well poised and prepared to deal with any emerging contingency"

In the months after the report was finalised, there have been border tensions in at least two areas of Arunachal, with a corresponding increase in the number of forward deployed troops. Following the tensions, special representative-level talks took place, following which a Corps Commander level meeting was held earlier this month to resolve differences. "At ground level, Border Personnel Meetings continue with the PLA in all sectors in a cordial and friendly environment to resolve issues of concern," it says.

On Op Sindoor, the report notes successful strikes by Indian armed forces that neutralised terrorist infrastructure in Pakistan and incurred heavy losses on its armed forces. However, the report also notes that there was a gap in the ability of the Indian industry to supply drone and anti-drone products during the Operation, which is being addressed through fast-track development.

Past Valuation at \$2b

►► From Page 1

Brookfield had made a formal bid during the last sale process but talks had stalled before being revived a few months back.

For Blackstone, monetising the investment from its first Asia fund—is crucial ahead of deployments from its third fund, according to sources. Blackstone Capital Partners (BCP) Asia III closed at a record \$13.1 billion in June 2026, marking its largest-ever private equity fundraising for the Asia-Pacific. In the interim, it had explored multiple options such as a continuation vehicle for PGP, but those efforts did not come to fruition.

Blackstone and Brookfield declined to comment.

In the past, Blackstone had sought a \$2 billion valuation, which most experts now regard as difficult to achieve, given energy market volatility due to the West Asia conflict. Oil prices rose more than 8% week-on-week as attacks on tankers and energy facilities in the region fuelled concerns over extended supply disruptions. Brent crude futures for November delivery traded at \$104.09 per barrel on Friday, up 8.1% from the week before. Sources close to Blackstone, however, said that business has been resilient, with profit up 20% in FY26.

The company, founded as Gujarat Gas Ltd, was renamed Piramal Glass in 2008 after the Piramal Group acquired it. It was delisted from Indian exchanges in 2014.

PGP Glass has operations in India and Sri Lanka with an overall capacity of 1,720 tonnes per day, 12 furnaces and 70 production lines. It has offices and warehousing facilities in France, Germany, Turkey, Spain, Brazil, India, the UAE, UK, and Sri Lanka. PGP Glass serves customers in over 50 countries, according to the company website. About 77% of its sales come from high-end cosmetics and specialty spirits.

In FY25, the company's consolidated total income grew by 4.4% year-on-year to ₹4,278 crore, while ebitda reached ₹1,430.2 crore, up 5.1%.

Support for Farmers, Startups

►► From Page 1

"Therefore, within the BRICS group, we have placed special emphasis on strengthening resilience. It is equally important to identify challenges in time, be prepared for them, and take prompt action," the PM said.

In this context, the PM said that India's BRICS presidency has focused on four pillars — resilience, innovation, cooperation, and sustainability, adding, "I am pleased that, with all your cooperation and support, we have been able to translate our shared vision into win-win cooperation."

Modi referred to BRICS support for logistics, farmers, startups, innovators and disaster management during India's presidency. "We have agreed on a BRICS In-

tegrated Early Warning System for the prevention of and response to infectious diseases," he said. "Early Warning Data Integration Guidelines have been prepared for disaster management. The BRICS Logistics Supply Chain Cooperation Framework will help make our supply chains more reliable and resilient."

Other initiatives will foster better networking among new enterprises. "Under innovation, the BRICS Incubator Network will connect our startups and incubators with one another. To promote innovative and scalable solutions, we have proposed the BRICS Startup Innovation Fund," he said.

The BRICS Network on Digital Agriculture will create new opportunities for farmers, Modi sa-

id. "Through this initiative, AI, geospatial technology, and Digital Public Infrastructure will be connected to the real needs of farmers," he said.

He pointed out that India's endeavour has been to ensure that BRICS cooperation does not remain limited to governments. "We have sought to make our ent-

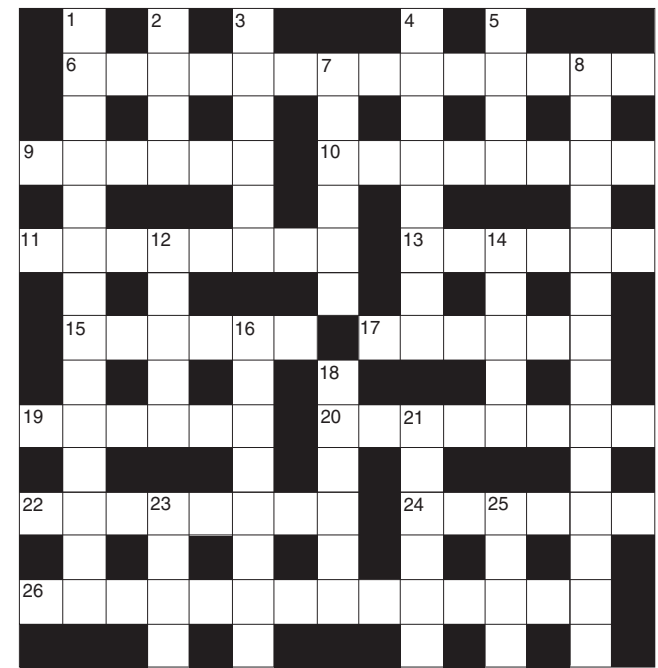
repreneurs, farmers, researchers, women, youth, and ordinary citizens active participants in it," Modi said. "Through BRICS Connect, we have promoted skills, employability, women in the workforce, social security, and capacity building. To connect small enterprises with knowledge, finance, and new markets, we have initiated the BRICS MSME Cooperation Portal. The BRICS Urban Mobility Hub has been established to faci-

litate the sharing of best practices among our cities."

BRICS has also sought to ensure protection of the environment. "In Indian civilisation, nature has been accorded the status of a mother," Modi said. "Within BRICS as well, we have emphasised the need to strike a balance between human development and the environment... For Smart Grids and Energy Storage, we have established the BRICS Digital Centre of Excellence."

Crossword

9703



ACROSS

- 6 Sacking issued to drillers? (8)
- 9 Overtaken gravestone having no epigram (3,3)
- 10 Sidney's swimming in Middle East in his imagination (5,3)
- 11 Where 'eco-slops' decompose? (8)
- 13 No passion by a priest at start and end of homily (6)
- 15 I'll earn it once I'm sorted out (6)

- 17 Imagine setter's off changing puzzle (6)
- 19 Selected stockings in suburbs of Cwmbran (6)
- 20 Swirling Yule wind's difficult to handle (8)
- 22 Both came, possibly making huge sacrifice (8)
- 24 Tuppence in state benefit? That's no problem (6)
- 26 Perhaps innets getting rash from it? (8,6)

DOWN

- 1 Irishmen vote MP out in destitute state (14)
- 2 Forbidding storyteller on radio (4)
- 3 Deprived area got the bats (6)
- 4 Caught leaving a function organised for spring (8)
- 5 Day Brutus changed side (4)
- 7 Agile, but broke limb in northeast (6)
- 8 Music version of Butler's 'Haydn' absorbs Her Majesty (6,3,5)
- 12 Dismisses sound of instrument (5)
- 14 He arrived from Europe to fish (5)
- 16 Chap at home keeps old battered instrument (8)
- 18 Insect follows smell, sweet (6)
- 21 Weird guest occasionally reveals small device (6)
- 23 Cousin's mother's emaciated? Not good (4)
- 25 Time for fruit (4)

SOLUTION TO No. 9702:

ACROSS: 1 Uncages. 5 Clause. Formula. 10 Neutral. 11 Oca. 12 Stipulation. 13 Tutor. 14 Slavishly. 16 Grey whale. 17 Ensure. 19 Disobedient. 22 Old. 23 Whinger. 24 Tapster. 26 Peeled. 27 Aintree. **DOWN:** 1 Upright. 2 Carmarthenshire. Gnu. 4 Swami. 5 Consultate. 6 Aruba. 7 Straight shooter. 8 Clingly. 12 Screw. 14 Slandered. 15 Inept. 16 Go down. 18 Endorse. 20 Bage. 21 Extra. 25 Pin.

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ED PROBE INTO FLOW OF FUNDS TRANSFERRED BY TMC TO CAREWELL & RELATED ENTITIES

TMC Paid Over 2X Average Rate for Carewell Jet: ED

TMC used aircraft for about 224 hrs over 4 years & paid Carewell around ₹37.17 cr

Raghav Ohri

New Delhi: The Trinamool Congress (TMC) paid substantially more per flying hour for an aircraft operated by Carewell Aviation India Pvt Ltd than the average rate charged by the company to its other clients, according to details emerging from the Enforcement Directorate's investigation into the party's bank accounts and its dealings with the aviation firm.

Agency sources said an analysis of the aircraft's flying records and receipts showed that TMC paid an average of ₹16.56 lakh per flying hour for the Embraer Legacy 600, compared with an average of ₹7.68 lakh per hour received by Carewell from other clients during the period examined.

The data gathered indicates that the rate paid by TMC was approximately 2.15 times the av-

FIR & ECIR

Probe stems from FIR by Bidhannagar Cyber Crime Police and an ECIR under the PMLA

verage rate received by Carewell from other customers, people in the know told ET.

According to ED's analysis, the disparity became particularly pronounced in 2026. "TMC paid an average of ₹28.04 lakh per flying hour for the aircraft, identified as VT-KOL, while Carewell's average receipts from other clients stood at approximately ₹8.90 lakh per hour during the same year — a difference of more than three times," an official told ET.

The federal agency has examined the aircraft's operations

over four years. In 2023, TMC used the aircraft for about 12 hours and paid ₹2.12 crore, translating into an average receipt of about ₹17.53 lakh per flying hour.

In 2024, its utilisation was about 82 hours, with payments of ₹12.74 crore, or approximately ₹15.50 lakh per hour. In 2025, TMC used the aircraft for about 96 hours and paid another ₹12.74 crore, translating into approximately ₹13.27 lakh per hour.

In 2026, ED's data shows that TMC used the aircraft for around 34 hours but paid ₹9.56 crore, taking the effective rate to approximately ₹28.04 lakh per flying hour. Taken together, TMC's usage during the period totalled approximately 224 hours and 27 minutes, for which Carewell received about ₹37.17 crore.

The ED's investigation stems from an FIR registered by the Bidhannagar Cyber Crime Police Station.

Price Pressures

►► From Page 1

This had already forced Saudi Arabia to cut production by about a quarter month-on-month to 6 million barrels per day (mbd) in August.

"Any further disruption to Saudi barrels would remove more supply from an already tight physical market, leaving buyers competing for an increasingly limited pool of alternative crude," said Nikhil Dubey, lead analyst, Refinitiv, at analytics firm Kpler. "This would add further upside pressure to crude prices."

The affected pipeline supplied Saudi crude to the Red Sea port of Yanbu, from where India has been receiving about 9% of its imports since the Iran war began. "Indian refiners would not only need to find replacement volumes, but also suitable crude grades that provide the right product yields (middle distillate heavy) to meet domestic demand," said Dubey. Refiners would be forced to turn to costlier alternatives, including higher freight, he said.

While waiting to assess the extent of damage to the Saudi pipeline, allegedly caused by drones sent by Iraqi militias, Indian refinery executives are concerned that attacks on Saudi energy infrastructure may not slow any time soon.

"Inventories have so far played a crucial role in balancing the market," the International Energy Agency said in its latest report, adding that since the start of the war, global oil inventories have fallen by 507 mb, equal to an average draw of 2.8 mbd. Supplies have been squeezed owing to the conflict.



Union home minister Amit Shah in Mumbai on Sunday — IANS

Krishna Kumar

Mumbai: The Uniform Civil Code (UCC) will be implemented in all BJP-ruled states before 2029, Home Minister Amit Shah has said in Mumbai on Sunday. He said the government would deport every illegal infiltrator, including Bangladeshis, from the country.

"We have introduced a common civil code (UCC) in several states and I'm confident that before 2029, the 21 BJP-NDA ruled states will introduce UCC," Shah said while announcing plans for a 30-day 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan'. This begins from Prime Minister Narendra Modi's birthday to mark the completion of 25 years of Modi's tenure in public service — from the time he was Gujarat CM to being the prime minister, he said. He said that under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership, the country was free of the three festering wounds of corruption, casteism and dynastic politics. "Under Modiji's leadership, the country has seen politics of performance. The country has progressed and we have seen for the first time the foreign policy having a spine. For the first time, whether it be defence or foreign policy, we are going by what is in India's interests," Shah said. Under Modi's leadership, the country has become free from policy paralysis and alliance compulsions that crippled earlier governments. He spoke on the issue of the government's 'zero tolerance' to terrorism.

On the recent GenZ protests, Shah said the BJP believed in democracy and dialogue. "We are in a democracy. People have a certain view on several issues and bringing it out is also necessary. This is a BJP run government, we will not rule by imposing emergency. That is the Congress culture. We have our own culture (which is why), we have discussions and dialogues."

On whether the NRC in Manipur would have the 1951 baseline and the deadline for NRC nationally, Shah said, "We are talking to our allies and to political parties in Manipur on both the issues."

On the Indian and Chinese views on the LAC, he said, "The people of the country have faith in us. Some things are sensitive which cannot be publicly said as it is not in the country's interest or not in the interest of our armed forces."

HIDATO

FIND THE PATH - SOLVE THE PUZZLE

Complete the grid so that numbers 1 - 68 connect horizontally, vertically or diagonally.

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Difficulty: ★★☆☆

Hidato Sol.

Yesterday's puzzle solution.

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7 LITTLE WORDS

Find the 7 words to match the 7 clues. The numbers in parentheses represent the number of letters in each solution. Each letter combination can be used only once, but all letter combinations will be necessary to complete the puzzle.

CLUES	SOLUTIONS
1 lawyer's workplace (9)	_____
2 surrounds (8)	_____
3 University of Florida home (11)	_____
4 like some coastal rivers (5)	_____
5 large city on Hokkaido (7)	_____
6 awards for coming in 3rd (7)	_____
7 brass section members (5)	_____

COU

AL

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GAI

BOO

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HO

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TID

Yesterday's Answers: 1. BONDS 2. FORTHWITH 3. HORIZON 4. BRICQHE 5. SELMA 6. BEDSIDE 7. CRABAPPLE



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Dr. Dinesh Chidambaram
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FASM (Arthroscopy), Shoulder Fellow (Japan)
Consultant Arthroscopy,
Joint Replacement and Trauma



Dr. C. Karthikeyan
MS (Ortho), DNB (Ortho), MRCS (ED)
Fellowship in Arthroscopy (Shoulder & Knee),
Diploma in Sports Medicine (Swiss),
shoulder fellow (Italy)
Consultant Arthroscopy and Sports Medicine



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After Missteps, Thermax Puts Energy Back on Growth Path

ET Q&A **ASHISH BHANDARI**
MD & CEO, THERMAX

Thermax's push into new-age energy and clean-tech businesses has not been without missteps. But it has learnt from its mistakes and has begun to put the house in order. Its MD & CEO Ashish Bhandari details the transformation and the direction it is taking in an interview with **Kalpana Pathak** and **MC Govardhana Rangan**. Edited excerpts:

Over the past few years Thermax has had a bumpy ride. Why and how are you fixing it?
Right after Covid, it was also a period when, for several years, we had not grown. The question was: how would we want to look at the future? With that idea, in 2020-21, we wanted to create Thermax as a trusted partner to our customers in energy transition. That was an important statement because it meant we would actively work on energy transition and everything around energy efficiency.

What did not go well for Thermax?
On the industrial project side, we

took a couple of government projects that involved a high amount of civil and construction work. We did not do a good job of execution or of managing the customer. The last time we did a project was in 2022. We are cutting down on businesses that are long-cycle, government-related, L1 tenders and have high civil and construction requirements.

BUSINESS SENSE

We are cutting down on businesses that are long-cycle, govt-related, L1 tenders & have high civil and construction requirements

Is that only for government contracts or others too?
Even otherwise. There are systematic changes taking place. Executing projects is getting tougher if you do it the old way. Labour in India is becoming tougher to find, while weather-related issues are getting worse. Even if you are executing a project in Gujarat, you suddenly get rains that would traditionally happen once in a decade or so. They are happening more frequently. Migrant labour that you could trust is very transient now. Your ability to train them, build them up, and get them to be productive is therefore no longer something you can take for granted.

You entered the bio-CNG space too, which did not go well. What is the direction it is taking?
We entered this space with the expectation that we could execute the plan with a certain capability, based on achieving a certain feedstock availability. Within that was 'parali' grass. We set up projects, but the feedstock was not what was promised. And therefore, the output was not what we had committed. In trying to get this right, we lost some amount of money. For three years now, we have not taken a single order in bio-CNG. But now, we are ready.
Then there is First Energy, the platform we started for renewables. We could have executed it better. It involved getting into right-of-way issues and working with state governments. That is something we are realising is not something we excel at.

How did you overcome these setbacks?
We reorganised the company around industrial products, which are product-related businesses; industrial infra, which is project-related; green solutions; and chemicals. These became four parts of Thermax, and that is how we now operate and report the company. When we did this, a few things started to work well and a few less so.

Historically, Thermax is mostly a boiler company for the common man. What are the building blocks that you are putting in place now?
There are numerous stories that are working extremely well. Even in the last four years, each year we have been able to grow our top line and bottom line year-on-year. Despite the first quarter we had this year, we expect to recover nicely. Today, we have a backlog of ₹14,000 crore, which is by far the highest we have had in the last 12 months. After the Covid year, this is the highest growth we have had on orders side. As that starts to show up in the backlog, the numbers will start to look better. We also really like the quality of orders we have had in the last couple of years. We have also made a big shift into biomass, biomass bo-

ilers and build-own-operate models around biomass. We are not only among the best in local markets but can compete with anybody globally.

You have global businesses too. How are they faring?
You will see a different part of Thermax starting to show up regularly, backed by many of these growth levers. The last lever of growth is international. In multiple geographies, Thermax is setting up local legal entities capable of providing services and executing projects locally. We are qualified to deliver projects for most of the big names in Middle East in oil and gas. International orders comprise 30% of Thermax's orders. From both a top-line and bottom-line perspective, this is becoming very relevant to how we look at the future.

What makes your international business?

I am bullish on our international orders. They are driven by three large sectors. One is the US, particularly data centres. The second is Middle East oil and gas. The third is Africa, where we are working with larger downstream customers.



COMPANY PHOTO

OVERSEAS PUSH

International orders are driven by US, particularly data centres, Middle East oil and gas, and Africa

DELHI PG TRAGEDY

Experts Call for Regulated Student Housing Ecosystem

Faizan Haider

New Delhi: The recent tragedy in Delhi where students living in unorganised environments lost lives in a building collapse has underlined the need to move towards a regulated, institutionalised student housing ecosystem, experts said.

India today has over 43 million higher education students, yet organised student housing serves less than 0.5% of total enrolments. "Millions of migrant students are therefore left relying on unorganised facilities that often operate without standardised building codes, regular structural audits or adequate fire safety compliance," said Anshuman Magazine, chairman & CEO, India, South-East Asia, Middle East & Africa, CBRE.

To regularise and scale safe student accommodation, authorities and urban planners can adopt a comprehensive policy approach. "Recognising professionally managed student accommodation as a distinct real estate asset class would allow for unified safety certifications, space per bed norms and single window municipal licensing. Integrating student housing into urban master plans through Transit-Oriented Development corridors, by permitting higher Floor Area Ratio and mixed-use zoning near metro lines and major university clusters, would also make struc-



turally compliant, organised housing financially viable for developers and accessible for students," Magazine said.
Encouraging Public-Private Partnerships through Design-Build-Finance-Operate-Transfer frameworks could further help educational institutions modernise hostel infrastructure without straining institutional capital. Experts said that setting transparent regulatory standards and unlocking organised investment will bridge the demand supply deficit, while ensuring safe, high quality and resilient living environments for students across the country.
"Student housing in India has grown rapidly, but the standards around safety and management need to keep pace with that growth. When parents send their children to another city to study, they are not just looking for a room, they are trusting the accommodation provider with their child's safety," said Bharat Agarwal, founder and director, AURUS luxury managed residences.

Mumbai Housing Now Builds on Redevelopment Projects

Share of such projects in city's housing sales rises to 15% between FY25 and the first half of 2026

Kailash Babar



Mumbai: The redevelopment segment in Mumbai, the country's largest and costliest property market, has emerged as a major driver of housing activity, with more than 1,000 projects since 2020 and its share of residential sales more than doubling over the past decade.
Redevelopment accounted for 15% of Mumbai's total housing sales between FY25 and the first half of 2026, up from around 6% between 2016-2021. The segment now contributes around 13% of the city's overall residential supply, signalling a growing shift towards redevelopment as developable land becomes increasingly scarce.

Sales of redevelopment projects are now consistently exceeding new project additions, marking a structural shift in Mumbai's housing market, showed JLL and Naredco Maharashtra data. The trend indicates that redevelopment is increasingly being driven by market demand rather than regulatory intervention alone.
"Mumbai faces a fundamental constraint that no regulatory framework can resolve: an abso-

STRUCTURAL SHIFT

Sales of redevpt projects are consistently exceeding new project additions, marking a structural shift in Mumbai's market, show data

lute scarcity of developable land. Redevelopment has transitioned from a commercial opportunity into an urban survival imperative. This is not a real estate cycle; it is the operationalisation of urban survival strategy," said Karan Singh Sodhi, senior MD, Mumbai MMR & Gujarat and Alternatives, India, JLL.
Mumbai has around 13,500 cessed buildings requiring urgent replacement, with the western suburbs accounting for 22.4% of the ageing stock and south Mumbai for 14.2%. "Redevelopment has evolved from a policy initiative into the primary engine of the city's housing supply, evidenced by sales now outpacing launches. This

structural shift, with active slum rehabilitation acreage nearly four times that achieved in the last 30 years, highlights the impact of policy interventions such as DCPR 2034, lower consent thresholds and cluster-focused reforms in accelerating project execution," said Kamlesh Thakur, president, Naredco Maharashtra.
Property values have risen sharply across redevelopment corridors, with Worli at ₹1 lakh-₹1.15 lakh per sq ft after 25-28% appreciation in three years, Bandra-Khar at ₹90,000-₹95,000 after 25-30% growth, and Chembur at ₹47,000-₹52,000 per sq ft, brokers said.
JLL's Sodhi said Mumbai's redevelopment market is seeing stronger buyer participation, with redevelopment accounting for a growing share of residential sales and a significant pipeline of projects across the city.
Five locations, Borivali, Malad, Andheri, Vikhroli and Goregaon, account for around 36% of redevelopment projects since 2020. The western suburbs accounted for 35-45% of redevelopment activity in terms of both new supply and sales during 2025-H1 2026.
Slum redevelopment has emerged as another major component of Mumbai's urban renewal pipeline. There are currently 1,202 active projects covering 321,858 hutments across 2,156 acres, nearly four times the acreage completed in the three decades since the formation of the Slum Rehabilitation Authority (SRA) in 1995.

PwC India, US Entity to Set Up Consulting JV for Global Push

40K-STRONG TEAM Operating control of JV firm to rest with PwC India, while US co will own 50.1%

Our Bureau

Mumbai: PwC India will enter into a joint venture with PwC US, combining the local firm's consulting business with the latter's India-based acceleration centres (ACs) to create an entity with 40,000 employees at launch, said Sanjeev Krishnan, chairperson, PwC India. The firm's partnership in India voted on Saturday to approve the planned joint venture with PwC US by a large majority.

PwC US leader Paul Griggs and senior US partners are in India to work through the final details of the deal. The JV will be subject to regulatory approvals including that of the Competition Commission of India and will see PwC US own a 50.1% share and PwC India 49.9%. The operating control, including of the US-run ACs, will rest with PwC India, Krishnan said.

The new entity will comprise PwC India's consulting business (management and technology consulting, risk consulting) and the acceleration centres of the US firm in India. PwC India's audit, tax and transactions businesses, and other government advisory related work would not be part of the JV.

"This is PwC India being trusted to drive global growth," Krishnan said, pointing to India's large and increasingly sophisticated talent pool. The restructuring will create a separate consulting-focused entity within the broader PwC India operation.

The move will allow PwC to have a bigger common pool of resources to draw upon for global mandates, as competition intensifies for consulting and technology consulting assignments among the Big Four, as well as technology consultants and strategy firms. It will also enable PwC's Indian business to get access to global capabilities and partners more easily. The JV comes at a time when global professional services firms are increasingly using India as a strategic delivery and capability hub.

"The firms that win will be the ones that stop thinking about markets, capabilities, and delivery as separate pieces. That's what makes this combination so po-



werful," said Griggs. PwC US senior partner and CEO. "We're bringing the full breadth of our advisory talent in India together with PwC US—one team with the relationships, expertise, and scale to deliver for our clients and the PwC network."

Krishnan will also be the CEO of the proposed JV. PwC India currently has a workforce of about 33,000. With the addition of the acceleration-centre workforce, the combined platform will significantly expand its scale.

Krishnan said that with this JV, the firm would aspire to grow five-fold in three years, compared with the threefold growth in five years articulated in PwC India's Vision 2030. The deal is expected to take PwC India from a \$1.3 billion business to about \$2 billion on day one, subject to regulatory approvals.

Given that more than half of the combined India revenue of the Big Four—Deloitte, PwC, EY and KPMG—of around ₹50,000 crore comes from technology and management consulting, the firms are scaling up aggressively.

"This isn't about where work gets done. It's about building something clients can't get anywhere else: the best of PwC, brought together around their biggest opportunities, wherever they operate," said Griggs.

DTH Firms Set Aside over ₹11k cr to Meet Licence Fee Demand

Taking Precaution

DEMAND BY MIB	PROVISIONS
Dish TV ₹7,203 cr	Dish TV ₹4,866 cr
Tata Play ₹4,548 cr	Bharti Telemedia ₹4,487 cr
Sun Direct ₹2,107 cr	Tata Play ₹2,331 cr
Bharti Telemedia Not disclosed	Sun Direct Not disclosed



Javed Farooqui

Mumbai: DTH operators have made provisions of more than ₹11,000 crore against disputed licence fee liabilities as of March 31, 2026, in response to demands raised by the ministry of information & broadcasting (MIB), according to regulatory filings. The industry, meanwhile, is awaiting a government decision on reducing the DTH licence fee from the current 8% of adjusted gross revenue (AGR).
Tata Play has provided ₹2,331 crore against an MIB demand of ₹4,548 crore and has further recognised ₹3,232 crore as a contingent liability. Bharti Telemedia has provided around ₹4,487 crore. The company, which operates under the Airtel Digital TV brand, has not disclosed the demand raised by the MIB.
Dish TV's provision stood at about ₹4,866 crore against a demand of ₹7,203 crore up to FY25, while Sun Direct faced a demand of ₹2,107 crore towards additional licence fee for the period from FY08 to FY24. The MIB's demands relate to the computation of DTH licence fees, which are currently levied at 8% of AGR. The Cabinet had approved new DTH guidelines in 2020, reducing the licence fee to 8% of AGR from 10% of gross revenue. In April 2021, the MIB issued provisional licences valid for 20 years to DTH operators.

In 2023, the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (Trai) recommended that the MIB reduce the DTH licence fee to 3% of AGR and eventually phase it out by the end of FY27. The MIB is in the process of reviewing the DTH licence fee structure amid pushback from the All India Digital Cable Federation and Reliance Jio. Between March 2022 and March 2026, the DTH industry lost nearly 18 million subscribers amid structural shifts in the linear TV industry, including

the migration of premium customers to OTT platforms, the shift of price-sensitive rural viewers to DD Free Dish and the rapid adoption of connected TVs. Dish TV CEO Manoj Dobhal said these headwinds have affected DTH players across India and globally and may continue in the coming years.

According to financial data from the four companies, their combined revenue dipped to ₹8,200 crore+ in FY26 from nearly ₹10,000 crore in FY25. To overcome the slowdown in their core DTH businesses, operators are pivoting towards IPTV, broadband and OTT aggregation. Dish TV has also ventured into the smart TV segment, bundling smart TVs with OTT subscriptions as OTT consumption shifts from mobile devices to connected TVs.
To be sure, the DTH licence fee case is sub judice and pending before the Telecom Disputes Settlement and Appellate Tribunal (TDSAT), various high courts and the Supreme Court. DTH operators have challenged the quantum and applicability of the licence fee as well as the imposition of interest.

While the MIB has sought pending dues based on 10% of gross revenue (GR), DTH operators have contended that the fee should be calculated on AGR and apply only to the DTH business. The MIB's DTH licence demands have been stayed by some high courts, including the Jammu & Kashmir High Court.

The DTH licence dues are also subject to reconciliation based on the outcome of the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) audit and various court cases pending before the TDSAT, the high court of Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh and the Supreme Court of India.

In a Nutshell

Manipal Health Plans Expansion, AI Push

NEW DELHI Manipal Health Enterprises is setting its sights on expansion in various states, including Telangana, Kerala, and Delhi-NCR, while pivoting towards a "physical plus digital" healthcare model driven by artificial intelligence (AI). The healthcare major is actively evaluating strategic opportunities in Telangana, Kerala, Andhra Pradesh, and Chhattisgarh to selectively deepen its presence in identified markets, Manipal Health Enterprises said in its annual report for FY26.

'Consumer Spending on Aashirvaad to Double'

BENGALURU Diversified conglomerate ITC expects consumer spending on its flagship food brand Aashirvaad to double to ₹20,000 crore over the next five years as it expands into newer food categories and adjacent segments, a senior company official said. The company is amplifying Aashirvaad's play with a two-pronged strategy for the brand—strengthening its core atta (wheat flour) business while expanding into adjacent categories such as ready-to-cook foods and frozen snacks, said Hemant Malik, CEO, Foods Division, and executive director, ITC.

Faster & Cheaper: Artificial Intelligence's the New Superstar of Indian Microdramas

Shows in this segment made with use of AI may increase to 80% over next 18 months: Cos

Rajesh N Naidu

Mumbai: Rapid adoption of artificial intelligence (AI) is changing the content dynamics of the microdrama segment of India's entertainment industry.

The share of microdrama content created with the help of AI is likely to rise to as much as 80% over the next 18 months from 20-25% now, founders of microdrama mobile applications told ET.

Since the beginning of AI usage, visual consistency in a microdrama series has been a key challenge.

But constant innovation by microdrama content creators has ironed out these problems materially. With AI, visual consistency associated with characters' looks,

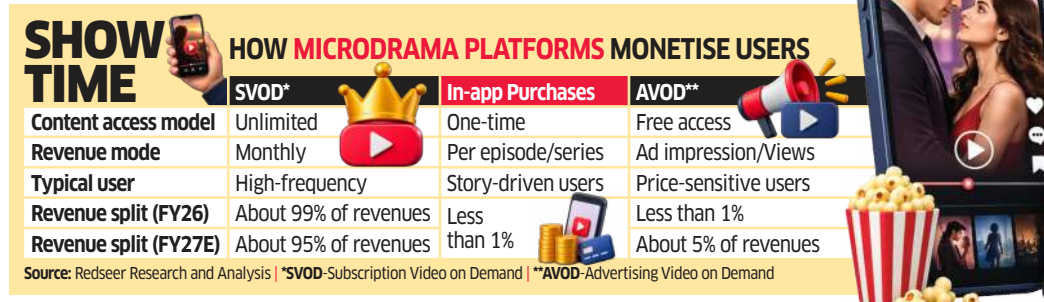
objects, locations and the feel of stories over longer-length episodes has been tackled. This has given confidence to microdrama companies that AI-assisted content will rise. "Today, AI is changing the economics of microdrama very quickly. In the next one year, I estimate that around 80% of microdrama content could be AI-generated, while about 20% will continue to be made through human-led production," said Vinod Kumar Meena, cofounder and chief operating officer at Kuku.
Two clear advantages support this trend. AI-assisted microdrama content materially reduces the time and cost for content creators. This has made the economics of producing microdrama content through AI more favourable.

Several microdrama content creators said production using AI is at least 30% cheaper compared with traditional ways of using human actors. Also, the time required to create microdrama content through AI is materially lower—it takes up to seven days for a 50-episode series compared with 30-45 days for traditional live-action production. According to a recent study by consulting firm Redseer, increasing use of AI is likely to reduce the production costs of close to 100-episode microdrama series to ₹5-6 lakh from ₹15-20 lakh in the next three to four years.
"Due to time and cost advantages, I anticipate AI-assisted

micro-drama content creation to surge to over 50-60% within the next year from the current 20-25% baseline," said Anshita Kulshrestha, founder and chief executive officer of TukTuk Entertainment. "This will set a new benchmark for scalable and mobile-first storytelling."

Increasingly, considerable improvement in AI-assisted language models has also added to the optimistic view about the rise of AI usage in microdrama content creation. Even audience experience of AI-assisted microdrama content has been favourable enough to encourage content creators to use more AI. Companies, which use AI as a tool for content creation, said there is huge scope for content creators to play with diverse themes and subjects through AI models.

"AI allows creators to imagine stories across diverse genres. The other advantage is scale," said Rahul Basak, cofounder of Round Table Media, a company which creates AI-assisted microdramas. Some firms said microdrama content involving humans could become premium content as AI-assisted content production increases.



New Delhi Scripts a Post-US Worldview

BRICS bring out a fresh rules-based order

The New Delhi Declaration, adopted by BRICS after bridging Gulf divisions, is a manifesto for a world no longer scripted in Washington. Yes, there's no mention of Russia's war in Ukraine. Instead, it speaks generally of 'ongoing conflicts' and 'polarisation,' and plants a red pin on West Asia, Palestine especially highlighted no longer just 'in spirit'. This omission and admission aren't accidental. It's the 'global south's' way of signalling that it also can cherry-pick its moral crusades. By opposing unilateral sanctions — those that bite hardest at Russia and Iran but makes countries like India collateral — BRICS has cast doubt on the legitimacy of the West's favourite weapon. Sold as the hallmark of 'rules-based order,' sanctions are now re-framed as what they really are: coercion. In effect, BRICS has declared that 'rules-based order' isn't confined to a US-led western wallpaper design.



India's diplomats called this 'engagement at various levels'. In truth, it's strategic autonomy in practice: consensus without capitulation, response to a growing vacuum. Each member retains its position, yet the collective voice is one of sovereignty and dialogue. Narendra Modi's call for UNSC reform

and financial institutions that reflect 'current economic realities' dovetails neatly with this posture. The 'global south' is tired of being in the front row of crises, but the back row of decision-making.

This is the architecture of a post-US worldview. Not anti-West, but post-West. As Sun Tzu observed, 'The supreme art of war is to subdue the enemy without fighting.' By refusing to fight the US' rhetorical battles by discounting them, BRICS has subdued the narrative itself. Critics may call this denial a refusal to confront. Yet, exclusion itself is power. By having India and China, Iran, Saudi Arabia and the UAE in one tent, BRICS has shown a world order outside the creaking post-1945/1947 framing. The West may still have the tech, weaponry and economic heft. But BRICS has found the words to register and act upon the West's wobble.

Tighter US Visa Isn't All That Bad for India

Tighter visa requirements for Indians studying or working abroad will intensify competition in the domestic market for white-collar employees. It will also bridge some of the skill gap Indian recruiters confront in local higher education. Western economies are raising the salary threshold for work visas, which tend to favour specific industries where demand props up wages. This has led to a concentration of foreign college degrees sought by immigrant Indian students, and the overall volume of students applying to universities overseas has declined. The supply response is being shaped by the adverse economics of acquiring a degree overseas.

The debt incurred to live and study abroad has become unserviceable for many students. Rising student indebtedness affects immigrants more than locals, whom they cross-subsidise. It works so long as the job market is competitive. Since western economies are erecting entry barriers to jobs, they will have to find alternative means of funding higher education. Some of the effects of stricter visa



conditions will be felt in excess college capacity these countries had built under an easier regime. This could encourage universities to become more proactive about overseas campuses.

As a relatively faster-growing emerging economy, India can absorb a reverse brain drain. The process will be aided by the growth of GCCs. Jobs are moving to where the workers are for a wide swathe of MNCs. Immigration controls will speed up the trend. Governments seeking to distort global higher education and employment markets risk exporting both colleges and offices to countries like India that export manpower. This should lower the cost of acquiring skills in India and have second-order effects on productivity when the prodigals return home.



JUST IN JEST

Khumb galouti, paneer lababdar, millet pulao, shahtoot phirni... anyone?

The BRIC-a-Brac Khana Xi Missed

Xi Jinping came to the BRICS party. But he — and crown prince of Abu Dhabi, Sheikh Khaled bin Mohamed, — skipped the dinner on Saturday, leaving khandvi mille-feuille to roll solo and khumb galouti to grill in quiet protest. The starters alone were a metaphor for multilateralism: gram flour tempered with mustard (India's spice), coconut (Brazil's tropical nod) and yoghurt (Russia's dairy diplomacy). Paneer lababdar promised soft power in tomato gravy while guchhi marmik — Himalayan morsels simmered with saffron and marmra almonds — was practically a UN resolution in a bowl.

Carrot bean poriyal toasted South Indian federalism in virgin coconut oil and millet pulao was a sustainable development goal disguised as comfort food. Even beetroot raita looked like a peacekeeping mission — cool, pink and trying to calm everyone down. Dessert was pure theatre. Old Delhi fruit cream with jalebi was nearly NAM-nostalgic while shahtoot phirni, topped with gold leaf, was India's way of saying: 'This is the kind of dessert we can be having after every meal if we become permanent member of the UN Security Council.'

Xi's absence became the evening's unintended garnish. But no matter. Perhaps, what the Chinese president needed after a long day was some hot chicken Scheszwan soup for the soul, that delectable, spicy and tangy Indo-Chinese dish, in his hotel room.

At BRICS, Modi and India provided an adroit demonstration of tactically gathering a motley crew

A Weekend in New Delhi



Ashok Malik

Hosting 20 countries — members and partners — at BRICS summit represented New Delhi's biggest diplomatic gathering since the 2023 G20 meeting. Expectedly, the event has generated much debate. The 45-page joint statement, too, has been read and interpreted widely. In the end, what does this amount to? Three points are worth noting.

● There is the familiar, but boring, question about the coherence of BRICS. This is not a trading bloc (Asean), or strategically aligned political collective (G7, at least in its good days). In some senses, it's a grouping constantly searching for a glue and making up for it by sharing economic, social and developmental, and occasionally technological experiences among a cohort of emerging economies.

While this is true, it is also a fact that more and more countries — middle powers if you will, developing countries if you prefer — are intrigued by BRICS. They are unsure about the gains, but don't see a real loss. They are willing to test its utility. This year, at the current juncture, despite its internal diversity — India and China are in a complicated relationship; Iran, Saudi Arabia and the UAE might as well occupy separate universes — BRICS found something to agree on. It became a forum of protest against:

► A scattershot tariffs and sanctions regime that has shaken the world economy.

► An impetuous conflict in the Persian Gulf that has now gone out of control and threatens an unending energy and food shock.

► Crippling of a multilateral institutional system that was far from perfect but, still, was the only one we had.

While individual grievances against Europeans and others might have been suggested, thrust of the BRICS message was not anti-West, or even aimed at the US. It was reflective of deep-seated frustration with specifically Trumpism. If anything, many of the countries would welcome a more active and involved America as a balancer to China, ironically even as China is in the room.



Thrust of the BRICS message was not anti-West, or even aimed at the US. It was reflective of deep-seated frustration with specifically Trumpism

It is a paradox that the US president has given BRICS some sort of a connective tissue — in terms of what it disagrees with, even if not what it agrees upon. This is a response to the moment and to immediate challenges, including reintensifying of the Gulf conflict on summit eve. Absent this context, the optics and language from BRICS would have been different. As such permanence should not be assumed.

● Different leaders came for different reasons. The Chinese president arrived to revalidate his commitment to BRICS, but more than that as part of a series of diplomatic boxes he is ticking before his visit to the US later this month. There he will meet an embattled host, boxed in by foreign policy and electoral conundrums. To whatever extent, the New Delhi stop has added to Xi Jinping's cards.

For Narendra Modi, the BRICS weekend became an occasion to demonstrate India's appeal. For all its problems, this country remains a pillar of stability, standing steady amid ferocious geopolitical and economic winds in a year from hell. This explains why invited countries wanted to come and stay engaged with India. (Bangladesh was the one exception, but that is another story) That aside, in convening even Persian Gulf rival states and drafting a statement that while admittedly a compromise — which 45-page document isn't? — offered language that everyone could take home, Modi and Indian diplomacy did themselves proud.

● BRICS is an unusual organisation in that the sum of its parts is greater than the whole. Cumulative bilateral and, where available, sub-regional affinities surpass any overarching identity. Consider India's guest list — 10 co-members of BRICS and 10 partner countries. Each of them denotes a trade or similar nexus that makes conversation important. A BRICS summit provides a convenient occasion to touch base.



Putting some back into BRICS



India's well-being and economic security can't be met by offering humbug arguments about how India is a western-aligned country, or by suggesting it can at all ignore the West. Reality and realism are much too complex

This point is often underappreciated by those who insist New Delhi must walk away from BRICS and limit its solidarity to the West, where India's biggest markets, its tech and capital sources, and its upcoming trade agreements lie. The contention about the West is correct. Trade pacts with, say, the EU and Canada, Britain and the US, open up markets for Indian manufacture, whether engineering and electronics goods, refined petro products or food items.

Nevertheless, crucial supply chains and commodities and ingredients linkages that <enable> such exports run through BRICS family countries. These range from crude oil (UAE, Saudi Arabia, Iran, Russia) to gas (Nigeria), metals (Bolivia), fertilisers (Kazakhstan), fertilisers (Egypt, Russia, Uzbekistan, Saudi Arabia), specialised coal (Indonesia, South Africa, Russia) and industrial equipment, electronics components and pharma APIs (China).

From the semiconductor ecosystem (Malaysia) to aerospace (Brazil), there are other incoming and capacity-building opportunities. One is not even going into the expanding export basket (including defence exports) with many of these countries, admittedly with the exception of China.

What is the big message? It is that in today's each-man-for-himself world order, India's well-being and economic security cannot be met by offering humbug arguments about how India is a western-aligned country, or indeed by suggesting India can at all ignore the West. Reality and realism are much too complex. They call for far too many intricate networks and tactical arrangements. Each of these adds up. Over the past two days, Modi and India provided an adroit demonstration.

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Thaw on the China Front



Harsh V Pant

Xi Jinping's visit to New Delhi for the BRICS summit — his first visit to India in 7 years — marked an important, if carefully calibrated, moment in India-China relations. The important point is that neither side has abandoned its assessment of the other. Rather, both are attempting to establish mechanisms through which competition can be managed without escalating into crisis.

The language surrounding the Modi-Xi meeting in Delhi is revealing. Both argued that India and China should regard each other as partners, not rivals. The central proposition: differences should not become disputes.

For Xi, this reflects Beijing's interest in stabilising its external environment amid trade and supply-chain uncertainty, tensions with the US and regional instability. So, he stressed calibrating perceptions, leveraging each country's strengths, supporting each other's BRICS presidencies and coordinating in institutions such as the UN, SCO and G20. His call for India and China to remain 'good neighbours and friends' signals Beijing's preference for managing differences while preserving space for cooperation.

Modi, however, framed the relationship around India's established principles of mutual respect, sensitivity and interest. His call for a fair, reasonable and mutually acceptable boundary settlement underscored that economic and multilateral cooperation cannot indefinitely substitute for progress on LAC.

India's reaffirmation of its positions on Taiwan and Tibet, along with its assurance that its territory would not be used for anti-China activities, signalled reassurance. New Delhi appears willing to acknowledge Chinese sensitivities but expects reciprocal restraint and stability from Beijing. The visit offers reasons for cautious optimism.

► **Diplomatic normalisation** Xi's return to India, the ceremonial welcome and renewed leader-level dialogue represent evidence that, since Galwan, the two sides are moving away from diplomatic paralysis. Regular political contact can create channels for managing future crises.

► **Economic opportunity** India cannot insulate its growth trajectory from China. Greater trade, investment and people-to-people contacts could ease some of the frictions. But progress will depend on Beijing addressing Indian concerns over market access, investment restrictions and the trade imbalance.

► **Selective cooperation** Uncertainty surrounding US trade policy, tensions in West Asia and vulnerabilities in global supply chains provide areas where Indian and Chinese interests may overlap. Such cooperation reflects pragmatic alignment where interests coincide.

The BRICS framework gives India and China a space for engagement without requiring alignment on the broader international order. India wants BRICS to remain a broad 'global south' platform while China is more willing to use it to challenge the West. Their approaches differ, but BRICS engagement serves both.

Limits of the rapprochement are critical.

► The core boundary dispute remains unresolved, military deployments and infra development continue, and strategic mistrust has not disappeared. India and China compete across the Indo-Pacific, technology, the 'global south' and the neighbourhood.

► India remains concerned about excessive dependence on Chinese supply chains and tech. Security considerations will continue to shape economic policy.

► Differences over BRICS reflect a larger strategic divergence. India seeks a multipolar order that allows it to work simultaneously with the US, Russia, China and other partners. China seeks an international environment less dominated by the US. These competing visions will constrain the depth of cooperation.

The thaw should be understood as managed competition rather than reconciliation. Both have recognised that uncontrolled deterioration carries high costs, but neither has altered its strategic posture.

Xi's visit is best seen as a milestone in the post-Galwan stabilisation process, not as a reset of ties. For durability, 3 factors will be key: sustained peace along LAC, progress on economic and people-to-people ties and continued political engagement.

India and China are unlikely to become close strategic partners very soon. New Delhi's objective should not be to eliminate competition with Beijing but to ensure that competition remains bounded, predictable and manageable.

The present moment is best described as stabilisation without strategic trust, engagement without reconciliation and cooperation without convergence.

The writer is professor of international relations, King's College London

A Declaration, No Roadmap



Saibal Dasgupta

BRICS put India's diplomatic heft on display on Saturday, as New Delhi cobbled together a consensus that led to the New Delhi Declaration (NDD), despite conflicts of interest among member countries.

The key question now is what happens next as the grouping prepares for its next chair, China. To address this question, one must recognise that each member views

BRICS differently, shaped by its own compulsions. For instance, India got the grouping to decry the Pahalgam terror attack of 2025 while Iran lobbied to ensure NDD condemned military strikes on it.



Hand Chinese

Though NDD reiterated the group's earlier resolution to support India and Brazil as permanent UNSC members, it set no timeline. There's clearly a Chinese hand in this: China, 1 of the 5 veto-wielding UNSC members, is unlikely to share power with new members. It has

repeatedly blocked Indian efforts to move UN resolutions against Pakistan's terror activities. This is significant because Narendra Modi demanded a time-bound plan to make it happen. Speaking at the BRICS Summit, Modi said UNSC reform "can no longer be postponed" and called for negotiations to have a definite timeframe and clear outcomes.

Though BRICS stresses partnership among member states, China is pushing for leadership of the 'global south'. Its strength rests partly on being the bloc's biggest trader, running trade surpluses with most BRICS members. India, the world's biggest democracy and fastest-growing major economy, is unlikely to accept unilateral Chinese leadership in Asia when BRICS itself calls for a multipolar world.

Xi Jinping presented a competitive face by inviting BRICS members to join World Artificial Intelligence Cooperation Organization, launched in July, to compete with the US in AI rule-setting. China has used a similar strategy before, positioning itself as a hub of international activity by launching SCO and persuading BRICS to locate its New Development Bank in Shanghai. India's approach is different: it

wants developing countries to jointly shape rules for high-tech sectors, rather than remain 'rule-takers'. "We must strive to transform the global south from a 'rule-taker' into a 'rule-shaper'," Modi said.

China, which usually pushes BRICS towards a confrontational stance on the US, appears to have mellowed. Xi's speech stopped short of sharp criticism of the US, possibly because he does not want to foul things up ahead of his meeting with Donald Trump in Washington on September 24.

Modi has made it clear that he does not want BRICS to become an anti-West lobbying group. Brazil and South Africa are also disinclined to adopt an aggressive posture towards the US. Russia and Iran, the biggest victims of economic sanctions, want the group to challenge US policies more forcefully. At least 3 members — UAE, Saudi Arabia and Indonesia — would do little to alienate the US.

Without BRICS, Russia would be gravely isolated as western countries have distanced themselves from it since the start of the Ukraine war in 2022. The group also provides Vladimir Putin with a platform to enhance relations with leaders of different countries that buy Russian goods. Nearly 90% of Russian oil and 60% of its weapons are bought by China and India.

Iran persuaded the group to include a reference to protecting peaceful nuclear facilities. Isolated by western-led institutions, it regards BRICS as a key forum to air its grievances and enjoys strong backing from Russia. South Africa sees BRICS as central to its foreign-policy identity beyond the African continent. Under Lula da Silva, Brazil used BRICS to push hard for reforms in IMF and WTO. But he skipped the meeting as Brazil heads into an election year.

It is difficult to spot many deliverables in the carefully hedged joint declaration, peppered with boilerplate phrases such as 'reaffirm', 'encourage' and 'welcome'. A few actionable decisions stand out: disaster management, anti-drug operations, a solar photovoltaic roadmap and credit assessment for export-oriented MSMEs.

But there is no sign of a united resolve to tackle major political and economic issues such as US tariffs and non-tariff barriers, imbalanced trade between BRICS members, or the exchange of high-end technologies. The declaration reiterates the earlier resolution to settle trade in local currencies rather than relying on the dollar but offers no roadmap or institutional structure to scale it up.

With no timelines for implementation and most plans lacking institutional structures needed to execute them, it is difficult to say if or when many of these decisions and resolutions will take shape.

The writer is former Tol Beijing correspondent



THE SPEAKING TREE

Destroy Old Files Totally

OSHO

I have heard that in the White House a president was very worried because many files had accumulated. He told his secretary to destroy all those files which were useless and to only keep those which were of any use. The secretary ordered many people to first make copies of the files in case something was needed some time, and then to destroy the files. This is how bureaucracy works. Now, this is unnecessary work: you are destroying the file but keeping a copy!

We go on accumulating useless memories, imagination, desires that we know are unfulfillable, still we carry on. Hence our emphasis has been on how to empty the inside of our being. There is no need to keep any copies because the more spacious we are, the more conscious we become, and that consciousness is enough to respond to any situation.

As one empties oneself, one becomes aware that less the burden, more efficient one is. One is not carrying ready-made answers, so one can see reality and respond. Otherwise, the mind always reacts, it never responds. It uses the old ready-made answer that may not fit at all; and then you fail.

A man of absolute emptiness always has the right response. He never fails, he never repents, he never feels guilty, he never looks back. Each act is finished so totally that there is no question of thinking about it repeatedly. He simply moves ahead, unburdened of the past.

Abridged from Meeting with individuals/ Courtesy Osho International Foundation/ www.osho.com



Velouria The Pixies

The Pixies' 'Velouria', from their 1990's album Bossanova, is a love song picked up by a radio telescope. Its guitars surge and glitter. Kim Deal's bass gives the melody a pulse. Somewhere behind them, a theremin seems to announce that ordinary gravity has been suspended. Yet, for all its glorious strangeness, the song is tender. Black Francis sings as though he has found someone miraculous and is slightly astonished she might just stay.

The line, 'We will waste in the shine of the ever' has planetary vibes to it while



having the contours of the human heart. A small promise between two people is turned

for a brief stretch of a bar into a place they might enter together. The words feel less written than discovered, as if Francis briefly remembered a dream and then goes into the chorus of 'My Velouria, my Velouria/ Even I'll adore you, my Velouria' — with its brazenly childish rhyming — to go find it again.

'Velouria' has the force of a rock song and the delicacy of a half-remembered summer. The song leaves you longing for some distant future nostalgia.

Chat Room

Forging Unity In Division

Apropos the report 'BRICS Adopts New Delhi Declaration by Consensus, Navigates Iran-UAE Divide' (Sept 13). The New Delhi Declaration is a triumph for Indian diplomacy. By mediating consensus among divergent nations, India reinforced its role as bridge-builder. The call for "dialogue and diplomacy" navigated fault lines while emphasis on energy security and trade corridors addressed shared vulnerabilities. A firm stance against unilateral tariffs and sanctions aligned with Global South priorities. The declaration reflects a balanced compromise, strengthening India's influence in shaping collective outcomes. Sanjay Chopra, Mohali

MAJOR STEP TOWARDS ‘MOTHER OF ALL DEALS’

India to Get 6.94 LT Steel Export Quota Under EU Free Trade Pact

Quotas cover stainless steel products, pipes & tubes, hot-rolled sheets & strips, metallic-coated & cold-rolled sheets

Our Bureau

New Delhi: India will get country-specific tariff-rate quotas (TRQs) of 1.64 million tonnes annually to export steel products to the EU. Under the country-specific quotas, India gets 946,616 tonne under the Most Favoured Nation (MFN) component and 694,853 tonne under the FTA component.

The quotas cover stainless steel products, pipes and tubes, non-alloy and alloy hot-rolled sheets and strips, metallic-coated sheets, and cold-rolled sheets, among others. The rest of the 940,000 tonnes are under the most favoured nation (MFN) component.

The two sides concluded the talks for an FTA in January, which is expected to be signed later this year and come into force the first quarter of next year.

The European Commission Friday formally submitted its proposal to the European Council to sign and finalise the FTA with India, marking a major step towards implementing the “mother of all deals”. At present, India exports about four million tonnes of steel annually to the EU.

As per the text, the largest country-



specific quota is for non-alloy and other alloy hot-rolled sheets and strips at 5.09 lakh tonnes, followed by cold-rolled sheets with a total quota of 2.18 lakh tonnes and metallic-coated sheets with 1.97 lakh tonnes. It added that the TRQs relating to imports into the EU of steel products originating in India shall take effect on the date the EU Steel Regulation starts applying. The TRQs follow the EU's Steel Overcapacity Regulation, which came into force on July 1 this year which aims at ensuring pro-

tection for the bloc's steel industry against the effects of global overcapacity. It sets free-of-duty quotas at 18.3 million tonnes, with a 50% duty for out-of-quota imports and a melt-and-pour regime to enhance transparency.

Steel imports from India outside these quotas will attract the applicable base-rate duties under the EU's tariff commitments. “If the European Union amends the Product Specific Rules (PSRs) for products covered under the EU Steel Regulation, the European

Union shall consult with India immediately upon the proposal for such an amendment,” the text said. The EU would administer the TRQs, it said, in a transparent, objective and non-discriminatory manner so as to be conducive to trade and facilitate, to the extent feasible, their effective utilisation.

This includes making publicly available in a timely and continuous manner all relevant information concerning the administration of those TRQs.

It added that India will also get access to additional quota volumes in categories where India has a country-specific quota. Those additional volumes will be allocated through competition among EU FTA partners that have country-specific quotas in those categories. For product categories where India does not have a country-specific quota, it will have access to residual quotas, including general residual quotas open to eligible trading partners and preferential quotas reserved for EU FTA partners.

The agreement also provides for periodic reviews of the quotas, with the first review to be initiated one year after the FTA comes into force and subsequent reviews every five years.

AS ₹1 L CR OMO MAY NOT BE ENOUGH TO DRAIN SURPLUS LIQUIDITY

RBI May Shift Govt Borrowing Towards Shorter Tenures in H2

Rozebud Gonsalves

Mumbai: Traders expect the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to tilt the government's borrowing programme toward short-term securities in the second half of the fiscal year, which could help absorb surplus liquidity in the banking system.

Issuances in the 5-7 year segment are likely to remain in focus, even as the RBI announced a ₹1 lakh crore open market operation (OMO) auction for the last two weeks of September. The OMO sales are unlikely to materially alter expectations of higher short-term borrowing, as the planned ₹1 lakh crore OMO sale may not be enough to absorb the banking system's excess liquidity.

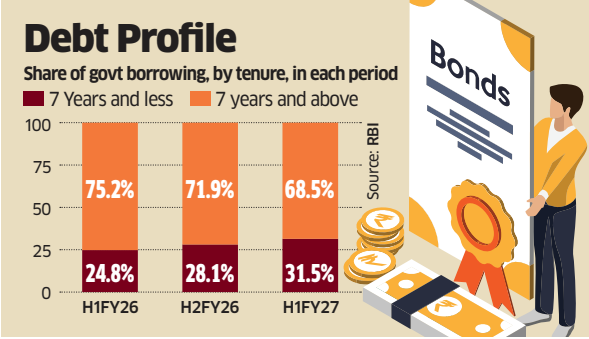
Traders said short term bonds should make up 35% of total borrowing. It was 28% in the corresponding period last year and 31% in the first half of this fiscal year.

The RBI, on behalf of the government, will announce its borrowing calendar in the week of September 28, and is expected to raise ₹7.9 lakh crore in government bonds.

Last year, in the second half the government had borrowed ₹6.77 lakh crore.

“There is strong banking appetite in the 5-7 year bucket, and this points toward enhanced short end bond issuance by the RBI,” said Vidya Iyer, head—fixed income, ICICI Prudential Life Insurance Company.

The strong appetite for these bonds comes as banks have recently seen a surge in liqui-



dity following massive inflows of \$136.4 billion under the FCNR(B) scheme, significantly above market expectations. The higher than expected inflow prompted the RBI to reassess how to absorb the extra liquidity.



Traders said short-term bonds should make up 35% of total borrowing

The daily average surplus in September so far is ₹10.25 lakh crore. The daily average was at ₹3.67 lakh crore in August and ₹1.07 lakh crore in July. Shailendra Jhingna, head of treasury at ICICI Bank also agrees with Iyer: “We think that the RBI will increase supply of bonds in the shorter end, given that the bulk of liquidity that has come in is in the 3-5 year bucket. With the yield curve this steep, it makes sense to increase short term issuances and take away from the long bonds,” Jhingana said.

The RBI announced on Friday that it will conduct OMO sales of ₹1 lakh crore in three tran-

ches in the remainder of this month. And while all the bonds listed for the current OMO sale fall in the 3-6 year bucket, this OMO sale is not enough for the RBI to drain excess liquidity.

The OMO announcement came hours after the RBI governor said in a media interview on Friday that all options to drain liquidity are on the table. Governor Sanjay Malhotra said that “nothing is off the table” and the central bank could consider measures like cash reserve ratio (CRR), market stabilisation scheme (MSS) and cash management bills to drain surplus liquidity.

“I think the OMO sale only conforms to the fact that the inclination is for issuance of short tenor bonds. The OMO should also be seen in the backdrop of reluctance from banks to participate in the 26 Day VRRR auction,” said AN Vinod, head of treasury, South Indian Bank.

The central bank conducted a 26-day variable rate reverse repo operation (VRRR) on Friday for ₹1 lakh crore, where banks bid just ₹60,449 crore.

India Inc’s Apprenticeship Participation Limited to 30%

Yogima Seth

New Delhi: India Inc's participation in apprenticeship training remains limited, with only about 30% of establishments registered under the government's National Apprenticeship Promotion Scheme (NAPS) actively imparting on-the-job training, government data showed.

Administrative hurdles, structural mismatches and candidate dropouts are among the factors holding back wider participation, as per industry insiders. Data from the NAPS portal shows that of the 1,98,183 establishments registered under NAPS, only 58,992 are actively imparting apprenticeship training under the scheme, creating a challenge for the government to push on-the-job training in the country to international levels. Industry executives said the delay in stipend payments from the government is impacting enrollments and prompting candidates to go for per-

manent jobs instead of apprenticeship training. “Companies are creating talent for themselves but are not very keen to register under the government's apprenticeship training scheme as there are issues with direct benefit transfer of stipends to the beneficiaries, which often results in unrest at the factory,” an industry executive said, requesting anonymity. The ministry of skills development and entrepreneurship (MSDE), however, said 2026-27 is witnessing a dip in dropout rates, which is expected to push up the number of apprentices this year. MSDE administers the NAPS. In an email response to ET's query, MSDE said that while the cumulative registration figure may appear lower than the previous year's annual total, the underlying registration trend remains encouraging, with the average monthly registration during FY 2026-27 at approximately 2.72 lakh candidates, which is higher than the average monthly registration of 2.56 lakh candidates recorded during FY 2025-26.

Industry is also often apprehensive about onboarding the scheme as a large number of candidates dropout in between. “The dropout rates continue to be high while the administrative hurdles at every step prevent companies from opting for the scheme,” said another executive. MSDE, however, said the average monthly completion rate has increased from 53,610 apprentices in FY 2025-26 to 68,424 apprentices in FY 2026-27, while the average monthly termination rate has declined from 36,351 apprentices to 20,507 apprentices.

Textile Industry Wants 6-month Extension for Duty-free Cotton Imports

Jayashree Bhosale

Pune: India's textile industry has demanded an extension of duty-free cotton imports by six months beyond October 31. The government had waived the import duty on cotton from June till October 31 to help the industry by increasing cotton availability and taming domestic prices.

Cotton prices have increased by about 20% in 2026, while the increase in cotton yarn prices is even higher. However, cotton farmers are worried that the extension of duty-free imports may suppress cotton prices when the new cotton crop arrivals start from the October harvest.



“We have requested the central government to extend the duty-free import window of raw cotton by six months as the cotton yarn prices have jumped 60% in 2026, adding to the challenges of the apparel exporters,” said KM Subramanian, president, Tiruppur Exporters Association (TEA), a major hub of knitted garment exports from India.

Cotton prices rose about 24% in the last six months as India's cotton production declined by 2.35% to 290 lakh bales of 170 kg in 2025-26. India's cotton production has been declining for the last six years, contracting more than 17% since 2021-22.

The government had exempted the 11% import duty on raw cotton from June to October 31 to make cotton available at competitive rates to the Indian textile industry.

“Yarn cost accounts for about 60% of the raw material cost of garments. Along with price increases, we are also facing a shortage of yarn availability,” said Subramanian. There are concerns about cotton production in the current year, which begins from October onwards.

“The rainfall situation is not good in cotton-producing areas like Vidarbha, Marathwada, Telangana and parts of Gujarat,” said Pradip Jain, president, Khandesh Ginning and Pressing Association.

Given the increase in input prices including fertilisers and seed, farmers are concerned about the possibility of extension of duty-free imports during the harvest period, as it can suppress domestic prices.

“Looking at the prevailing international cotton prices, imported cotton is not likely to be much cheaper than the domestic cotton. The domestic cotton prices may not fall below the current level of ₹9000/quintal. It will help to boost the availability of cotton for the industry,” said Jain.

Indian textile and garment exporters have been trying to benefit from the Free Trade Agreement with the UK and increase their share in new export markets after the tariff war with the US adversely affected India's exports.

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NOD TO MITIGATE GENERATION DEFICIT CAUSED BY FLOODS

India Okays Nepal's Request for 654mw Advance Import

Nepal's domestic generation capacity down by 550 MW

Shilpa Samant

New Delhi: The Centre has accepted Nepal's request for advance import approvals to off-take around 654 MW of peak electricity through power exchanges, but only in non-solar hours, people aware of the development said.

Kathmandu had sought advance import approvals effective September to mitigate generation deficits caused by the recent flash floods. This advance approval for power demand from Nepal comes at a time when India is witnessing unusual domestic needs due to sultry weather, irrigation demand through a rather dry monsoon season, and less wind and hydro electricity generation amid the El Niño effect.

Mail sent to the Ministry of Power remained unanswered until the publication of this report.

While solar hours are seeing sufficient generation to provide for the overall power demand in the country, non-solar hours have pressured coal-ba-

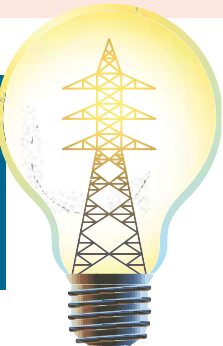
Meeting Demand

Nepal can take power from exchanges in non-solar hours

Non-solar hours power still needs available capacity

Nepal's generation capacity fell by around 550 MW

India faces peak demand pressure above 260 GW
Peak demand met 269 GW on September 10



sed and gas-based power plants. India's peak power demand has been hovering above 260 GW, which is unusually high for September. On September 10, the peak power demand met was 269 GW, while in the non-solar hours on the same day, peak demand was 236 GW, with a shortage of 6.1 GW.

The request to facilitate increased power flow to Nepal as needed has been processed in accordance with established frameworks, including trade through the day-ahead market and real-time market segments of the Indian power exchanges.

Kathmandu's request was to import electricity effective September - earlier than usual. Nepal traditionally imports electricity from India during the lean or winter

months starting October. So far in September, there has not been any major import by Nepal through the exchanges, according to data from the Grid Controller of India Ltd.

India also imports power from Nepal. While the flash floods in the Trishuli and Hende Khola river basin on August 26 caused severe infrastructural damage, including to power generation units in Nepal, the impact on India's national power grid is minimal and fully manageable.

Nepal's domestic generation capacity has fallen by around 550 MW due to the damaged facilities, an executive said. Cross-border power flow to India is currently reduced by around 400 MW from its previous peak export levels of around 950-1,000 MW.

Tata Sons' Listing to Open Up Funding for Electronics Arm

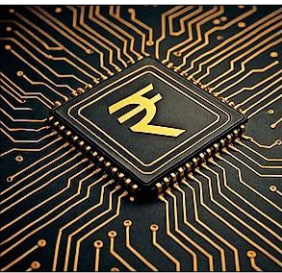
Debut will unlock public equity markets, ensure capex, say analysts

Our Bureau

Chennai: The listing of Tata Sons may be beneficial for the group as a whole as it opens up a funding route for its new, high-growth businesses such as Tata Electronics, which has become the fourth-largest Tata Group company by revenue.

Tata Electronics, founded in 2020, has rapidly scaled in the last four years to become one of Apple's largest contract manufacturers in India, competing with Taiwan's Foxconn.

Aside from electronics manufacturing, the company is betting big on semiconductor manufacturing. It is building India's first chip fabrication plant in Dholera, Gujarat—a ₹91,000 crore plant that will put India on the elite global map of countries that produce chips.



It is also building an outsourced semiconductor assembly and test (OSAT) facility in Assam for ₹27,000 crore, making it the only Indian conglomerate that is attempting to be India's first integrated player across the electronics value chain.

Under Tata Sons chairman N Chandrasekaran's leadership, around ₹9,961 crore has been pumped into the company. But it has not been smooth sailing as some Board members have questioned the long gestation period for returns on such large investments. At a Board meeting in May, Board members raised alarm over the losses of unlisted enterprises such as Air India, Tata Digital and Tata Electronics. Analysts believe

that in the case of Tata Electronics, the segment is challenging and will require continuous capex and time to get it right. Thus, a Tata Sons listing could provide much needed capital inflow for the company.

Tarun Pathak, research director, Counterpoint Technology Market Research, said the firm is one of the few anchor entities that are likely to push India's semiconductor fabrication ambitions and will serve as the foundation for integrating into global supply chains.

“But for this to happen, significant capex will be required. The most important factors for fabs to be profitable and successful are ‘yield’ and ‘utilisation rate’ and that doesn't happen overnight and will lead to continuous capital consumption at least for the first four-five years and will also require policy and regulatory support... A listed Tata Sons not only unlocks public equity markets, ensuring capex for group companies like Tata Electronics but also make sure that the investments are also not vulnerable to global IT services spending slowdowns.”



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It's going to be different to wake up the next morning knowing you've won the US Open and achieved the world number one ranking

ELENA RYBAKINA after defeating Aryna Sabalenka 6-4, 5-7, 6-2 in the women's singles final of the US Open late on Saturday night

WOMEN'S ASIA CUP FINAL

India Win Record Eighth Title
Dubai: Shafali Verma (39-ball 68) and Smriti Mandhana (39-ball 59) struck sensational half-centuries before Shree Charani snapped four wickets as India defeated defending champions Sri Lanka by 72 runs in the Women's Asia Cup final to clinch a record eighth title on Sunday.

BRIEF SCORES India: 183/5 in 20 overs (Shafali 68, Mandhana 59) defeat **Sri Lanka:** 111 all out in 20 overs (Athapathu 36; Shree Charani 4 for 20) by 72 runs

INDIA-AFGHANISTAN T20S

Easy Seven-wicket Win for Hosts

New Delhi: Arshdeep Singh choked Afghanistan with relentless accuracy and a slew of variations while Abhishek Sharma tightened the noose with a brutal 82 as India hardly broke a sweat in their seven-wicket victory in the opening T20I on Sunday. Arshdeep set the platform with 3 for 19 which included 16 dot balls, as the Afghans managed 156 for 8.

BRIEF SCORES Afghanistan: 156 for 8 in 20 overs (Omarzai 64, Nabi 33; Arshdeep 3 for 19, lost to **India** 157 for 3 in 13.4 overs (Abhishek 82, Ishan 42, Nabi 2 for 28) by 7 wickets

Norris' Loss is Kimi's Win

Antonelli reigns in Spain after Mercedes' 2-stop strategy backfires for defending champion

Kimi Antonelli extended his lead in the world championship with his eighth victory of the season at the Spanish Formula One Grand Prix at the Madring on Sunday.

The 20-year-old Mercedes driver finished clear of Max Verstappen (Red Bull) and Lando Norris (McLaren) and is now 81 points ahead of nearest rival, his Mercedes teammate George Russell, in the title race.

Ferrari's Charles Leclerc (Ferrari) finished fourth ahead of fellow Briton Russell and Liam Lawson in the second Red Bull.

Franco Colapinto (Alpine), Oscar Piastri (McLaren), Arvid Lindblad (Racing Bulls) and Niko Hulkenberg (Audi) rounded out the top 10.

Seven-time world champion Lewis Hamilton, who had scored points in every race this season, missed out completely, retiring his

Ferrari on lap seven because of brake failure.

George Russell was another big loser, with the Mercedes driver suffering badly from his team's decision to put him on two-stop strategy—the only one of the main runners to have this—which blew his chances of podium and left him even further behind his teammate in the title race.

Norris will also rue his team's poor strategy. The reigning world champion drove a blistering lap on Saturday to claim pole position and was leading comfortably until the intervention of the virtual safety car (VSC) on lap 15.

While Antonelli and Verstappen immediately dived into the pits to change their tyres McLaren kept Norris out for an extra lap.

As he prepared to come in, the VSC finished meaning he lost time against his rivals, and the Briton wasn't helped by a slow pitstop of seven seconds. By the time he came out Norris was down in fifth with Leclerc, who hadn't boxed, and George Russell also ahead of him.

New Attacks in Hormuz and Saudi Threaten to Deepen Oil Disruption

One killed, four injured after ship struck in Strait of Hormuz, Iranian authorities say

Aden | Dubai: New strikes on Saudi Arabia and vessels in the Gulf heightened tensions in the Middle East on Sunday, after an attack on a Saudi oil pipeline and an advance by Yemen's Houthis threatened to worsen wartime disruption to global energy supplies.

Oil traders expected prices to rise again when markets reopen on Monday, following weekend developments that jeopardised supplies from the world's biggest exporter, Saudi Arabia.

In the latest incidents in the Gulf, the British maritime security agency UKMTO said on Sunday that a vessel had been struck by a projectile while transiting the Strait of Hormuz, causing a fire and forcing the crew to evacuate. Iran, meanwhile, said one person was killed and four crew members wounded aboard an Iranian commercial vessel struck off its coast.

In Saudi Arabia, state media released video showing damage to homes and a mosque from what it



US DIESEL PRICES HIT RECORD

The politically sensitive retail price of diesel fuel in the United States rose on Sunday to another all-time high above \$6.20 a gallon

described as the latest cross-border attack by the Houthis in Jazan province in the south. The Houthis separately claimed to have struck a Saudi military base in a neighbouring province.

Southern Saudi cities have experienced regular alerts since last week, culminating in drone strikes on Friday that knocked out the 1,200-kilometre east-west pipeline across the Arabian Peninsula.

The pipeline has served as a main route for Middle East oil exports

that bypasses the Strait of Hormuz.

That same day, the Houthis captured Perim Island, which lies in the middle of the Bab El-Mandeb, the "Gate of Tears" strait controlling the mouth of the Red Sea.

US DIESEL HITS ANOTHER RECORD
Oil prices surged above \$100 a barrel last week for the first time since July. The politically sensitive retail price of diesel fuel in the United States rose on Sunday to another all-time high above \$6.20 a gallon.

Traders and Saudi oil buyers told Reuters on Sunday that Riyadh has enough oil stored at its Red Sea port of Yanbu to maintain exports for just five to seven days if the pipeline struck on Friday remains shut.

After that, as much as 4% of global oil supply could be jeopardised, on top of the millions of barrels a day already lost to disruption in traffic through the Strait of Hormuz. **Reuters**

Board to Discuss Monetisation Issue

► From Page 1

Any valuation set ahead of a listing could also influence the eventual post-listing value of Tata Sons and, in turn, the proceeds SP Group can realise from its remaining holding, the people said.

SP Group did not comment. Shapoor Mistry had discussed monetising the stake with Tata Sons chairman N Chandrasekaran and Tata Trusts chairman Noel Tata until July. Chandrasekaran announced early August that he would not seek reappointment when his term ends in February 2027 and has not participated in subsequent discussions.

The monetisation of SP Group's stake will now be tabled and discussed with the board of Tata Sons, people in the know told ET. The RBI directive could ease some of the pressure on SP Group from lenders and vendors by providing greater visibility on a potential route to monetise its Tata Sons holding, one person familiar with the matter said. A clearer listing path could also strengthen

then the group's ability to refinance its debt and negotiate with creditors and suppliers.

Talks between SP Group and Tata Sons have made limited progress because of differences over the structure and valuation of a potential transaction. Tata Trusts controls Tata Sons and Noel Tata has sought to preserve the holding company's private status, the people said.

One proposal discussed by the two sides involved a share swap under which SP Group would receive shares in a basket of listed Tata companies in exchange for part of its Tata Sons holding. The latest proposal envisages cash proceeds being paid to SP Group over a defined period, potentially allowing Tata Sons to avoid a listing, they said.

The valuation, funding mechanism, quantum and timing of any buyback remain unresolved, the people said.

"While SP Group has favoured a listing, it needs immediate funds to meet its debt requirements," one person familiar with the matter said.

"If the RBI mandates listing, it may still take a while. And SP Group needs to monetise some stake to meet its needs. How much stake will be monetised will depend on the valuations."

The RBI directive has revived expectations of a potential Tata Sons listing, but the timing of any public offering remains unclear.

For SP Group, the decision is also tied to pressing debt obligations.

The group completed a ₹21,500 crore refinancing in July, easing immediate funding pressure but leaving it with relatively expensive debt, the people said. Its borrowing costs are currently around 18%-19%, which the group is seeking to lower to about 12% through a future refinancing.

The July financing includes a make-whole provision for about 18 months, making an early refinancing expensive. The provision is expected to expire around June 2027, the people said.

SP Group has repayments of

about ₹3,500 crore due by the end of September, and lenders want to see tangible progress on monetising the Tata Sons stake before considering further refinancing or relaxing loan-to-value requirements, they said.

Failure to make the September payment could potentially constitute a default. The obligation relates to an earlier financing arrangement and was expected to be met from proceeds of the July funding.

SP Group's total borrowings are estimated at more than ₹50,000 crore across various entities and instruments, with exposure to domestic and international lenders, bond investors and private credit funds.

Some Have Conservative Outlook

► From Page 1

That was as against an eventual price discovery through an IPO.

In a letter dated September 11, the central bank rejected the plea of Tata Sons to surrender its licence as a non-bank lender, effectively paving the way for its public listing.

A leading global brand valuation firm sees further constraints on Tata Sons' value.

Future revenue could be shaped more by regulatory policies than royalties earned from group companies, it said. The firm also raised concerns about the infusion of trustees and directors once Tata Sons is listed, saying the trust's agenda may not remain as fluid as it has been in the past.

"That could make the future outlook 'extremely conservative' from a valuation perspective," the firm said. "A trust brand is also difficult to transfer or monetise, unlike assets that can be transferred and generate value relatively quickly."

The Tata brand should not receive a separate premium, said the head of equity capital markets at the firm. Brand benefits are already reflected in the market valuations of listed Tata companies, while group synergies are reflected in their revenues and margins. Adding a separate brand value would, therefore, amount to double counting.

Tata Electronics is expected to be the largest contributor to the unlisted portfolio. Its electronics manufacturing services business could be valued at about ₹78,000 crore, based on 0.65 times FY26 revenue of ₹1.2 lakh crore. Its semiconductor business could command ₹35,000-50,000 crore based on equity at risk and option value. The Dholera semiconductor fabrication is not fully operational, while the Assam facility is operational.

Air India, which continues to incur heavy losses, could be valued at an enterprise value of ₹22,000-36,000 crore using an EV-to-sales multiple of 0.3-0.5 times, the banker said. The valuation is net of debt.

A Mumbai-based investment banker expects a 30% holding company discount and said Tata Electronics and Air India would have little value at present, with investors likely to assign some option value based on future potential.

The India head of a global private equity buyout fund expects a 40-50% discount. The investor estimates Tata Electronics at \$6.8 billion, Tata Advanced Systems at \$5.6 billion and the insurance joint ventures at \$2.3 billion. Tata Digital would derive most of its value from Croma and Img, the investor said. Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) remains the biggest swing factor. A further derating could hurt Tata Sons' value, while a rerating could lift it significantly. Progress at the Dholera fab, including trials on schedule and off-take, and Air India's path to ebitda breakeven will also matter. Governance and succession concerns could weigh on valuation.

Meanwhile, SP Group has about \$5.1 billion of debt backed by its Tata Sons holding, including \$3.3 billion raised by Sterling Investment Corp in May 2025 and \$1.6 billion raised by Cyrus Investments in June 2023. The latest Equizen financing was primarily intended to refinance the Cyrus debt, with the balance for group requirements and transaction expenses.

PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE is hereby given to all concerned that, The State Bank of India Senior Officers' Co-operative Housing Society Limited ("said Society"), a co-operative housing society registered under the provisions of the Maharashtra Co-operative Societies Act, 1960 under registration No. Bom/HSG/1285 of 1966 having its address at Jayashree Building, 75, Abdul Gaffar Khan Road, Worli Sea Face, Mumbai - 400025 is a lessee of all that piece and parcel of land bearing Cadastral Survey No. 744 (forming part of Laughton Survey No. 3344), Plot No. 20 of the Worli Estate of Municipal Corporation of Greater Mumbai admeasuring approximately 2,000 square yards (equivalent to 1,672.26 square meters) and lying, being and situated at Worli Sea Face within the Registration District and Sub-District of Mumbai City ("said Land") which is more particularly described in the **First Schedule** hereunder written, along with the building standing thereon known as "Jayashree" ("said Building"). The said Land and the said Building is hereinafter collectively referred to as the "said Property".

The said Society is desirous of undertaking redevelopment of the said Property. The said Society has passed the requisite resolutions at its general body meetings for such redevelopment. In furtherance of the redevelopment, members of the said Society are entitled to opt for selling their respective residential premises to the selected developer or its nominee. As per the records of the said Society, the details of the members of the said Society and their respective premises are as outlined in the **Second Schedule** hereunder written.

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THE FIRST SCHEDULE

(Description of the said Land)

All that piece and parcel of land bearing Cadastral Survey No. 744 (forming part of Laughton Survey No. 3344), Plot No. 20 of the Worli estate of Municipal Corporation of Greater Mumbai, admeasuring approximately 2,000 sq. yards (equivalent to 1,672.26 square meters), lying, being and situated within the Registration District and Sub-District of Mumbai City and bounded as follows –

On or towards North : By Plot No. 19A of the Worli Estate
On or towards East : Partly by Plot No. 32A of Worli Estate
On or towards West : By 80 (Eighty) feet wide Worli Sea Face Road
On or towards South : By Plot No. 20A of Worli Estate

THE SECOND SCHEDULE

Sr. No.	Name of Member	Flat No.
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2.	Nita Gupta	11
3.	Sadashivgadh Trust	12
4.	Nainish Parekh	14
5.	Abhay Shah	15
6.	Sujit Kothari	16
7.	Pushpa Varshneya	21
8.	S.L. Saigal	22
9.	Meeta Vishnu	23
10.	Anjali Purohit	24
11.	Swati Vilas Jagtap	25
12.	Chitritra Mukherjee	26
13.	Chetan Shah	31
14.	Kusum Shah	32
15.	Vivek Shanbhag	33
16.	Shubhagi Vilas Desai	34
17.	Minali Goyal	35
18.	Jay Chemi Colour Pvt. Ltd.	36
19.	Surendra Shah	41
20.	Reena Manglik	42
21.	Sunita Manglik	43
22.	Arun Nagar	45 & 45 Terrace Room
23.	Jyoti Nagar	46

Dated this 14th day of September, 2026.

For Wadia Ghandy & Co.
Dhawal J. Mehta
(Managing Partner)



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Name	Shri. Sandip Rathod Shri. Prashant Sudewad Shri. Vaibhav Kamble
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E-TENDER NOTIFICATION

As per Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and 2000, Karnataka State Electronics Development Corporation Limited (KEONICS), Bengaluru invites tender through Karnataka Public Procurement Portal as given below. The information regarding the tender is made available in <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>. For any tender related queries or more information, Bidders may contact KEONICS during office hours. (Telephone Number 080-2222 5645).

Sl. No.	Tender Notification No.	Details of Tender	Last date to submit the tender
1	KEONICS/ 2026-27/ SE0140/ CALL-2	Request for Proposal for Selection of Service Provider for the Design, Development, Testing, Commissioning and Conducting Online Computer Literacy Test (CLT) and Digital Certification System for Government Officials and Staff of Boards and Corporations of Government of Karnataka(Call-2)	29.09.2026
2	KEONICS/ 2026-27/ INDO306	Tender for Empanelment of Vendors for Supply, Installation, Testing, Commissioning and Warranty of Scanners at Karnataka State Electronics Development Corporation Limited (KEONICS) for a period of 01 Year	01.10.2026
3	KEONICS/ 2026-27/ SE0142	"Empanelment of Agencies/ Firm for Providing Highly skilled and Skilled ICT Human Resource Services to KEONICS"	12.10.2026

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SMART INVESTING

An Oversold Nifty Could Witness a Short-term Rebound

TATA SONS LISTING ON THE HORIZON

SP Group Bond Holders Likely to Rake it In

Investors financing SP Group at yields up to 19% see better risk-reward after the RBI decision

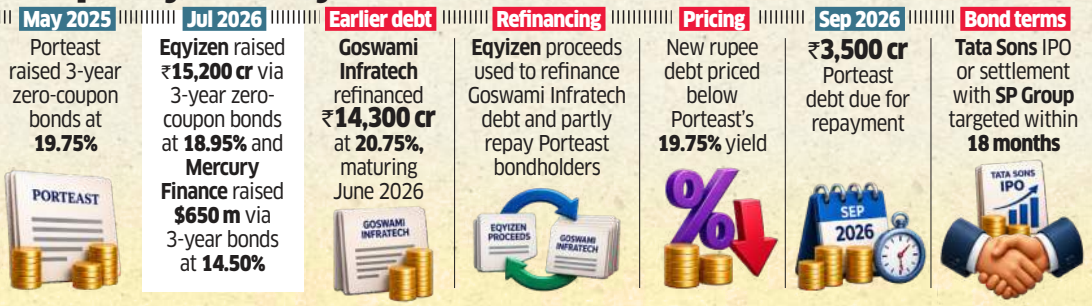
Shilpy Sinha

Mumbai: Yield on Shapoorji Pallonji Group (SP) bonds is expected to tighten significantly with the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) rejecting Tata Sons' application to voluntarily surrender its registration, thereby mandating listing of Tata Sons, people familiar with the matter said.

The Tatas and SP are also discussing settlement of the SP group's part stake in the Tata holding company, Ares Management, Davidson Kempner, Deutsche Bank, Farallon Capital, Cerberus Capital, Varde Partners, Blackrock and Broadpeak are among investors in the SP Group's bonds.

The RBI decision has improved the risk reward for investors who financed SP Group at yields as high as 19%, with the group's 18.37% stake in Tata Sons pledged as key collateral. Clear

Shapoorji Pallonji Debt Timeline



Group Weighs Repayment Options

Shilpy Sinha

Shapoorji Pallonji Group is weighing the option to raise funds or extend about ₹3,500 crore of debt due to Porteast and scheduled for repayment by the end of September, as the central bank's effective mandate of a Tata Sons listing provides clear path to investors for debt repayment, people familiar with the matter said. The RBI mandate would also build broader investor trust in the ability of the infrastructure conglomerate to monetise its stake in the Tata group holding company and meet future redemption commitments, they said.

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Is Senior Living An Option for You?

Riju Mehta

As old age creeps in, children move away, and spouses pass on, elderly retirees have begun to seek families among strangers, forging new bonds in homes away from home. 'Old age home' is no longer a despised alternative fobbed on unwilling parents; seniors are making this choice proactively. Their three-pronged needs—security, medical care, companionship—once met by the joint family structure, are now being outsourced to senior living facilities. "Senior living is no longer a choice people consider only when they need care; it is becoming a conscious decision," says Rajit Mehta, MD, Antara Senior Care. "Our only daughter is abroad and everyone around us was busy with their own lives. Here, we are involved in various activities all day long

and don't feel lonely," says Reena Lamba, 62, who, along with her husband, Amar Bir Singh, 70, shifted to Ashiana Nirmay, Bhiwadi in 2024. Despite the growing interest, the organised senior living market is heavily concentrated in the southern states. Some of the leading players include Vedaanta Senior Living, Primus Senior Living, Columbia Pacific Communities, and Manasum. Ashiana, Antara, and Athashri are the main developers in the North (Delhi-NCR) and West (Pune, Mumbai, Ahmedabad). Most active senior living facilities, located on the outskirts of bigger cities, are integrated, self-sufficient communities, with senior-friendly infrastructure, and facilities covering healthcare, safety, dining, recreation, social engagement and daily support.

Continued on >>> Smart Investing

Six listed group cos hold an estimated ₹1.4 lakh crore stake in Tata Sons; Tata Steel and Tata Motors PV each own 3.1%

Tata Sons Listing Seen a Positive for Group Stocks

Ranjit Shinde

ET Intelligence Group: The stocks of Tata group companies including Tata Steel, Tata Motors PV, and Tata Chemicals are likely to gain momentum after losing 8-22% on the bourses in three months. Investors are expected to price in stakes of these companies in Tata Sons as it inches closer to listing publicly following the RBI's instructions to comply with the regulations governing the upper-layer investment companies.

Each of these three companies hold 2.5-3% stake in Tata Sons, the group's holding company. In all, seven listed and two unlisted group companies hold between 0.4% and 3.1% stake each in Tata Sons.

For Tata Chemicals, the estimated value of its 2.5% stake in Tata Sons is around ₹30,000 crore, nearly two times its market cap of ₹15,597 crore. The stock has lost 18% in three months and 20% year-to-date. "Tata Sons' market valuation is estimated to be ₹11.9 lakh crore based on the value of its stakes in group companies.

Each of Tata Steel and Tata Motors PV owns around 3.1% stake in Tata Sons, amounting to ₹36,348 crore or 16% and 33% of their respective market caps in that order.

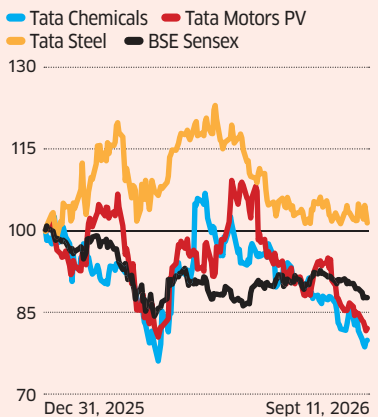
Other group companies including Indian Hotels, Tata Consumer and Tata Power hold 0.4-1.6% stake in Tata Sons. Together, these six companies hold an estimated ₹1.4 lakh crore worth of shares in Tata Sons.

Value of Group Stakes

	Stake in Tata Sons (%)	Stake value (₹ cr)	Market Cap (₹ cr)	CMP (₹)	3-mth chg (%)
Tata Steel	3.06	36,347.7	2,28,259.8	182.9	-7.6
Tata Motors PV	3.06	36,347.7	1,11,229.3	302.0	-22.4
Tata Chemicals	2.53	30,052.2	15,593.6	612.0	-18.0
Tata Power	1.65	19,599.2	1,16,629.9	365.0	-7.3
Indian Hotels	1.11	13,184.9	1,02,166.9	717.8	5.6
Tata Consumer Pdt	0.43	5,107.7	98,132.7	991.6	-9.9
Tata Investment Corp	0.08	950.3	32,940.1	651.1	-2.2
Tata International	0.37	4,395.0	Unlisted	—	—
Tata Industries	0.57	6,770.6	Unlisted	—	—

Market cap and Current market price (CMP) as of September 11, 2026
Stake value based on an estimated Tata Sons market valuation of Rs 11.9 lakh crore
Source: BSE, ET Data Team, ETIG

Year-to-date stock movement (indexed to 100)

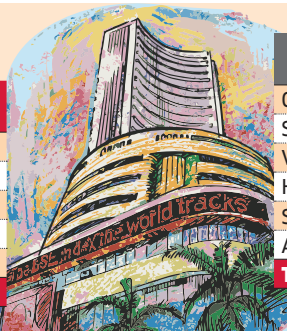


FIVE MAINBOARD & SIX SME COMPANIES TO FILE PAPERS

D-St Set for ₹24,500-cr IPOs This Week

Listing Line-Up

SME IPOs	IPO period	Issue size (₹ cr)
SS Retail	Sep 16-18	500.0
Jindal Supreme India	Sep 16-18	124.9
Hero Motors	Sep 16-18	1,000.0
NSE	Sep 17-21	22,561.6
Sonaselection India	Sep 17-21	141.6
Total		24,328.0



SME IPOs	IPO period	Issue size (₹ cr)
Quanto Agroworld	Sep 15-17	29.5
Shakti Polytarp	Sep 15-17	25.6
Vama Wovenfab	Sep 15-17	47.1
Kheria Autocomp	Sep 17-21	44.1
SpectraA Tech Solutions	Sep 17-21	40.4
Axiom Gas Engineering	Sep 18-22	47.3
Total		233.9

Source: BSE, NSE

Our Bureau

Mumbai: The truncated trading week ahead is set to be another busy one for the primary market, with five mainboard and six SME initial public offerings (IPOs) worth around ₹24,500 crore scheduled to open for subscription.

NSE's ₹22,561.5-crore IPO will dominate the week's primary market activity, accounting for more than 90% of the value of issues opening for subscription.

The issue opens on September 17 and closes on September 21. Markets will remain shut on Monday, September 14, for Ganesh Chaturthi.

The ₹24,500 crore worth of IPOs opening for subscription during September 14-18 would be the highest since October 2025, when issues worth around ₹29,000 crore hit the market during the week of October 6-10.

Among other mainboard offerings, Hero Motors, SS Retail and Jindal Supreme India will open on September 16 and close on September 18. Hero Motors will raise around ₹1,000 crore, while SS Retail and Jindal Supreme India will raise ₹500 crore and ₹125 crore, respectively.

Two mainboard IPOs—Veegaland Developers and Manika Plastech—that opened last week will close during the week. Six SME IPOs that opened last week will also close during the week.

STOCK MARKET DEBUTANTS

The week will also see a flurry of listings, with 10 mainboard companies set to make their stock market debuts. Pranav Construction will list on September 15, followed by Glass Wall Systems India, Prasol Chemicals and Kanohar Electricals on September 16. Six companies—Asset Reconstruction Co India, Manipal Payment & Identity Solutions, Steamhouse India, LCC Projects, Karamtara Engineering and Rentomojo—will list on September 17. Four SME companies are also scheduled to list during the week. Apana Logistics will make its debut on September 15, while Infrax Renewable, Vinod Texworld and Amtech Esters will list on September 17.

GROWING EQUITY West India led monthly recovery with a 40.9% rise in registrations

Gujarat Surges Ahead of UP in New Investor Additions, Adds 2.3 L in Aug

Ravindra Sonavane

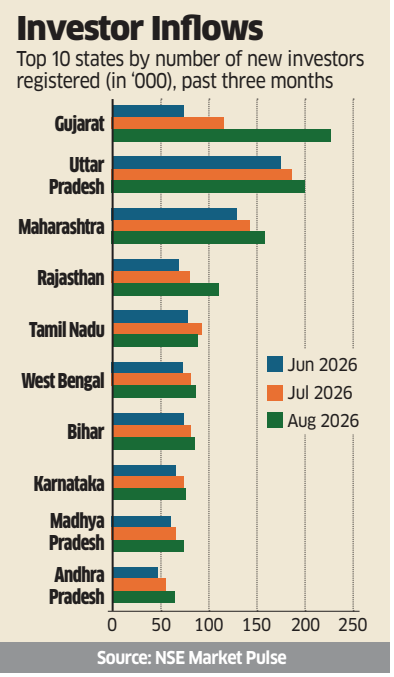
Mumbai: Gujarat emerged as the largest contributor to new investor registrations in August, overtaking Uttar Pradesh in adding new investors during the month, as overall registrations rose 16.7% month-on-month to 1.55 million.

Gujarat added 230,000 new investors in August, accounting for 14.6% of the monthly additions, followed by Uttar Pradesh with 200,000 investors, or 12.9%, and Maharashtra with 160,000, or 10.2%.

Rajasthan and Tamil Nadu followed with 110,000 and 90,000 new registrations, accounting for 7.1% and 5.7%, respectively. The top five states together contributed 50.5% of August's new investor registrations, NSE Pulse data showed.

Gujarat's performance stood out, with new registrations rising 94.8% month-on-month and 134.9% year-on-year. Rajasthan recorded the second-highest sequential growth among major states at 36.7%, followed by Haryana at 23.3%. Maharashtra and Uttar Pradesh saw registrations rise 11.2% and 7.2%, respectively.

The shift in leadership from Uttar Pradesh to Gujarat comes even as Uttar Pra-



des continues to have the second-largest registered investor base nationally. Gujarat's increase in new registrations made it the largest contributor to incremental investor participation during August.

Overall, new investor registrations rose 16.7% month-on-month and 24% year-on-year, marking an acceleration after relatively subdued registration momentum in the preceding months.

West India led the sequential recovery, with registrations rising 40.9% month-on-month, followed by North India at 12.4%, East India at 7.3% and South India at 3.6%. Despite the sharper monthly growth in West India, North India remained the largest source of new investors, contributing 590,000 registrations, or 38.4% of August's additions.

West India accounted for 460,000 new registrations, or 29.7%, followed by South India with 320,000, or 20.5%, and East India with 170,000, or 11.2%. The sharp increase in West India's registrations lifted its contribution substantially during the month, although North India continued to account for the largest share of incremental participation. During FY27TD, 6.16 million new investors were added.

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Just six weeks in, the framework is facing scrutiny over expiry-day swings, lower participation and algo misfires

CAS Set for a Rework: What’s Up for Change

ET PRIMER

Nishanth Vasudevan

Mumbai: India’s contentious new closing auction (CAS) has had a bumpy start. Barely six weeks after its launch, Sebi is already reviewing parts of the framework. Here’s what went wrong and what could change:

Why is Sebi reviewing CAS so soon after introducing it?
CAS has been around only since August 3, but its first few weeks have been chaotic.

The auction saw sharp swings in Nifty and Sensex, especially on expiry days. Options traders faced losses, algos misfired, and option premiums stayed high at expiry instead of decaying. Lower participation during CAS added to concerns, giving large orders more sway over closing prices in the auction.

Sebi’s own review has flagged movements in indicative index values during CAS and significant moves in some index options nearing expiry.

Before we go further, jog our memory. What exactly is CAS and what’s the big deal about it?
Until August 3, closing prices were

based on the volume-weighted average price (VWAP) of trades during the final 30 minutes. These prices set index levels, mutual fund NAVs and derivatives settlement.

CAS changed that. Normal trading in the 200-odd F&O stocks now ends at 3:15 pm, after which buy and sell orders are collected in an auction. Exchanges find the single price at which the maximum quantity can be matched, and that becomes the stock’s closing price.

The idea was to make closing-price discovery more robust and reduce the influence of large last-minute orders, while helping passive funds execute large trades closer to the official closing price.

Since key issues are around derivatives expiry, how does Sebi propose to deal with it?

Sebi has offered two alternatives for calculating the price at which index and single-stock derivatives will be settled on expiry days.

Option 1 is a blended VWAP combining trades during the last 30 minutes of normal trading with those during the 10-minute CAS. Their weight would depend on the actual value traded in each period, rather than any fixed proportion.

Option 2: temporarily return to the old VWAP system, using only the last 30 minutes of trading. CAS would still set cash market closing prices,

AI CONCERNS Strong demand for chips, energy, computing power likely to limit impact

Anthropic’s AI Warning May Weigh on Chips, But Trade Seen Intact

Bloomberg

AI executives’ calls to slow development of the technology are likely to weigh on chipmaker and supply-chain stocks in the near term, but will probably have limited long-term impact as spending on computing infrastructure remains strong, market watchers say.

Semiconductor makers and other artificial intelligence-linked stocks may bear the brunt of any initial selloff on Monday, while investors assess whether a more cautious approach to developing advanced models will crimp earnings. Still, with demand for chips, energy and computing power continuing to outstrip supply, any weakness may prove short-lived.

Calls for restraint have grown in the industry with Anthropic Chief Executive Officer Dario Amodei saying Saturday that the company would introduce additional safeguards, including independent third-party evaluations, and urged the broader industry to slow the pace of development of their most advanced models. OpenAI CEO Sam Altman backed the proposal, while xAI’s Elon Musk said “Dario is right.”

Investors including Gary Tan, a portfolio manager at Allspring Global Investments in Singapore, are doubtful the latest developments will have long-lasting effects on the industry.

“It may cause some short-term pressure, but it’s unlikely to derail the longer-term AI trade,” Tan said. “AI development is still at a relatively early stage, and I’m not sure the rest of the ecosystem is willing to accept the current pecking order and slow down while the technolo-

gy continues to evolve so rapidly.” Concerns over the vast sums being poured into AI have weighed on technology stocks as investors question whether earnings can justify soaring infrastructure costs. The scrutiny has left high-valuation shares linked to the technology particularly vulnerable, with signs of increased spending or weaker returns triggering selloffs.

The tech-heavy Nasdaq 100 Stock index has dropped more than 4% from the record notched in June, while a gauge of chip shares in the US has slumped 14% and Asian tech stocks have slid almost 8%. The benchmark S&P 500 Index and MSCI’s gauge of global shares have both edged up about 0.6% in the period.

Some investors argue that a slower pace of AI development could ultimately be positive for the industry by giving companies more time to extract returns from infrastructure already being built.

“The three CEOs agreeing to pace things does not really change the money being spent on chips, power and infrastructure. In fact, it extends the development timeline,” said Billy Leung, an investment strategist at Global X Management in Sydney. “If commercialization and adoption keep growing while the pace of new capability eases off a bit, that actually helps the shift from spending money to build things towards making money from what’s already built—e.g., monetization.” Sentiment toward Asian tech firms was already being challenged as traders firmed bets of a Federal Reserve rate hike this week and an increase in global borrowing costs this month, threatening to crimp profits.

SS Retail is Ringing Loud, So far in a Bustling Market

Mobile dependence, a Maharashtra-heavy business and supplier concentration a cloud over outlook amid competition

Snehal Mergu

ET Intelligence Group: SS Retail, a multi-brand retail chain, plans to raise ₹360 crore through a fresh issue to fund capital expenditure and working capital requirements. It will also raise ₹140 crore through an offer for sale. The promoter group’s stake will fall to 64.9% after the IPO from 75.7%. Around 89% of the revenue comes from Maharashtra, signalling geographic concentration. The company procures half of its inventory from top four suppliers, denoting heavy dependence. Aro-

und 86% of the sales are derived from mobile phone sales. The business is inventory-intensive requiring significant working capital and has strong competition from various stores such as Reliance Digital, Croma, Vijay Sales, Amazon and Flipkart. Given these factors, investors may wait to see the success of its efforts to improve geographic reach and sustainability of financial performance.

BUSINESS
Incorporated in 2016, SS Retail operates under its proprietary brands ‘SS Mobile’, ‘Mobile Exchange Wala’ and ‘The Mobile

SP Group Bonds could Gain Some Weight

►► From ET Markets Page 1

Tata Sons was retained in the RBI’s upper-layer non-banking financial company list for 2026-27 in August while its deregistration application was under consideration. It was identified as an upper-layer NBFC in September 2022 and had faced a September 2025 listing deadline.

With the RBI rejecting the application, the long-pending listing is back in focus.

Tata Sons had assets of around ₹2 lakh crore as of March 31, 2026, well above the ₹1 lakh crore threshold for the upper-layer category.

For SP Group, a listing would provide a clearer and more liquid route to monetise its pledged Tata Sons stake and repay debt. An alternative

is a negotiated settlement involving a buyback, share swap or entry of another investor.

ET reported on September 12 that SP Group chairman Shapoor Mistry had proposed a ₹25,000-crore payout over 24 months to Noel Tata, chairman of Tata Trusts, for a part of the Tata Sons stake.

Given visibility on repayment through listing, SP Group’s future borrowing costs would reduce significantly.

A person familiar with the transaction said the RBI decision had followed months of deliberation and was not taken in haste.

“The directionally clear picture is that there is a clear exit to the deal now,” the person said.

Group Weighs Repayment Options

►► From ET Markets Page 1

SP Group will decide whether to raise ₹3,500 crore for repayment or request for additional time to meet the repayment deadline, the person said.

Given a clear exit path for SP Group lenders through listing of Tata Sons, lenders would be receptive for an extension of the September 30 payment timeline, said people familiar with the developments. SP Group had raised ₹28,500 crore through NCDs in May 2025, at Porteast, which were backed by a pledge of a 9.2% stake in Tata Sons. The bonds were originally priced at 19.75%.

The refinancing comes as Shapoorji Pallonji Group’s debt investors gain greater visibility on a potential value-unlocking event at Tata Sons following the Reserve Bank of India’s rejection of Tata Sons’ application to voluntarily surrender its core investment company registration. SP Group had raised about ₹15,200 crore through three-year rupee-denominated zero-coupon bonds issued by Ezyizen Investment at a yield of 18.95%, alongside a \$650 million bond issued by Mercury Finance at 14.5%. The instruments were raised largely against the group’s Tata Sons

holding. Funds raised at the Ezyizen level were used primarily to refinance about ₹16,500 crore of rupee bonds at Goswami Infratech.

This request from SP Group would follow the regulatory rejection of a Tata Sons request for de-registration as an NBFC. Investor demand for SP Group debt has improved, with recent trades tightening and investors indicating that the earlier 18%-19% IRR reference level is no longer relevant following positive developments around Tata Sons, people familiar with the matter said.

Apart from Porteast, Ezyizen financing also carries a leveraging covenant requiring repayment of at least ₹13,500 crore within 24 months of issuance.



One keeps normal trading open longer and shifts CAS later; the other retains the 3:15 pm cut-off but wraps everything up faster. In either case, Sebi wants to reduce the time gap between normal trading and CAS and also shorten derivatives trading after the auction.

Why has Sebi become stricter about cancelling orders during CAS?
Because even an order during the auction that is later cancelled can influence prices and mislead traders.

In an August enforcement order, Sebi alleged that large orders in Sensex constituents were used to influence indicative prices in directions favourable to derivatives positions.

Sebi is now proposing that orders placed more than 1% away from the reference price cannot simply be cancelled. They can still be placed within the existing 3% outer limit, but can only be modified by raising the price of a buy order or lowering that of a sell order.

In short, Sebi wants to make it harder to withdraw orders that can sway the auction.

Why is SEBI worried about indicative index values during CAS?
Because they’re not actual traded levels, but evolving Nifty or Sensex estimates based on indicative prices of stocks in the auction. Sebi said these values could be mistaken as actual

index levels or used to take derivatives positions even as they change. It has proposed stopping indicative index values during CAS, while continuing to show indicative prices for individual stocks.

Do these proposals mean the current CAS is faulty and Sebi is abandoning it?

No. Sebi is not abandoning CAS. It is tweaking the framework after early experience. Some market participants see the review as an acknowledgement that the system needs to be adapted to Indian market conditions.

Which option for determining the expiry settlement price are market participants likely to prefer?

Prima facie, domestic market participants seem to be leaning towards Option 2: the temporary return to the old 30-minute VWAP for settling expiring derivatives. The reason is familiarity and predictability. Traders spent years with an expiry settlement price linked to actual trades during the final 30 minutes. CAS changed that rhythm abruptly.

How and when will Sebi finally decide?

Sebi has invited public comments on the proposals by October 3, 2026, but has not specified when it will take a final decision or when any changes will take effect.

TECHNICAL VIEWS

An Oversold Nifty Could See a Short-term Rebound

The Sensex and Nifty extended their losing streak to a fifth week, the longest in 14 months, with Nifty sliding nearly 2% and slipping below key moving averages. Analysts said the indices have entered oversold territory, leaving scope for a short-term rebound.

TANMAY SHAH
RESEARCH HEAD, SIHL

Trading Strategy:

Given the current oversold condition and the possibility of Nifty holding above the 22,950 support zone, traders can consider a Bull Put Spread for the September 29, 2026 expiry, by selling the 23,200 Put and buying the 22,950 Put. The strategy offers a favourable risk-reward profile while allowing traders to benefit from time decay if Nifty remains sideways or sustains above 23,200. The structure is suited to a cautiously bullish-to-neutral view for the month.

TOP STOCKS THIS WEEK

Kotak Mahindra Bank:
Buy | CMP: ₹419 | Target: ₹432-439 | Stop loss: ₹408
The stock broke out above ₹410, then retraced to retest the breakout zone. Support near the 20-day moving

average indicates buying interest at lower levels.

LIC Housing Finance: Buy
| CMP: ₹562.90 | Target: ₹598-615 | Stop loss: ₹539
Strong delivery-based buying over the past two weeks has lifted the stock sharply from the ₹480-490 support zone, reinforcing a positive price structure and sustained accumulation.

SUDEEP SHAH
HEAD - TECHNICAL AND DERIVATIVES RESEARCH, SBI SECURITIES

Nifty Strategy:

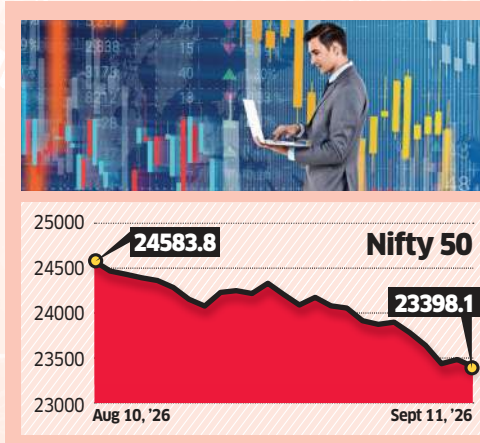
Nifty has slipped below key moving averages, with weak momentum, keeping bias tilted to the bears, though oversold conditions are emerging. A break below 23,000 could drag the index to 22,800-

22,500. On the upside, 23,600-23,650 is the key hurdle, with recovery signals only above 23,650. Nifty longs are advised only above 23,650, with a stop-loss at 23,450 and targets of 23,950-24,100, anticipating short-covering.

TOP STOCKS THIS WEEK

BHEL: Buy | CMP: ₹431 | Target: ₹447-455 | Stop loss: ₹420
The stock maintains a strong price structure, trading above key moving averages across timeframes. Buying support on dips and relative strength against the broader market keep the setup positive.

PNB Housing Finance:
Buy | CMP: ₹1,178 | Target: ₹1,240-1,276 | Stop loss: ₹1,130
The stock broke out above ₹1,130 in early August. Subsequent dips towards ₹1,130 attracted strong buying with rising volumes.



DHARMESH SHAH
HEAD TECHNICAL, ICICI DIRECT

Trading Strategy:

As long as Nifty holds Friday’s panic low near 23,200, a mean-reversion move towards 24,000 remains possible. Nifty has failed to beat the prior day’s high for 13 straight sessions. Historically, this setup occurred 34 times,

with 25 instances leading to double-digit average gains over the next 3-6 months. The index is also below its 200-day EMA, while the weekly Stochastic at around 17 is deep in oversold territory, signalling downside exhaustion. Any decline towards 23,100-23,200 in Nifty Spot should be used as a buying opportunity for a target of 23,500. Immediate support is

placed at 22,850.

TOP STOCKS THIS WEEK

Adani Ports: Buy | CMP: ₹1,765 | Target: ₹1,876 | Stop loss: ₹1,679
Buying demand has returned after the stock retested the 12-month rising channel breakout at the 200-day EMA, with the weekly RSI showing a bullish crossover that confirms the positive bias; recommended in the

₹1,710-1,765 range

BHEL: Buy | CMP: ₹430.60 | Target: ₹470 | Stop loss: ₹402
After a 14-week consolidation above the 50-day EMA, the stock is shaping into a bullish pennant, with a breakout likely to accelerate momentum; recommended for buying in the ₹420-430 range.

LENDER ALSO SEEKS SIX-MONTH TENURE RELIEF

One Insider, One Outsider in Contention for HDFC Top Job

Saloni Shukla

Mumbai: HDFC Bank has submitted the names of deputy managing director Kaizad Bharucha and one external candidate to the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for its top job, with the external choice made from a final set that included ICICI Prudential Life CEO Anup Bagchi and Citi India CEO K Balasubramanian, people familiar with the process said.

The identity of the external candidate ultimately submitted to the regulator could not be independently ascertained.

The lender has also sought a relaxation of about six months from the central bank’s tenure rules that would allow Bharucha, if selected, to complete a full three-year term as managing director and chief executive, the people said. If given a full term, Bharucha would otherwise have hit the regulator-mandated ceiling on directorial tenure before his corner-room stint were to end.

HDFC Bank’s search had started with a much wider field. The lender received more than 150 applications, of which around 50 were shortlisted and fewer than 10 bankers were eventually interviewed, people cited above said.

In the final stages of the external search, Bagchi and Balasubramanian emerged as the strongest contenders, they said.

“Bharucha remains the strongest internal candidate and the bank has sought a limited regulatory dispensation that would allow him to complete a full three-year term,” a person familiar with the process said. “For the external option, the board was looking for someone who had handled businesses of significant scale and complexity given the size of HDFC Bank’s balance sheet and franchise.”

HDFC Bank did not respond to queries seeking comment.

Bharucha offers continuity at a time when the lender is navigating a leadership transition and the continuing integration of the erstwhile HDFC Ltd business. He has been with HDFC Bank since 1995 and joined its board as an executive director in June 2014. He currently oversees a large part of the bank’s asset franchise, including retail assets, mortgages, corporate banking, emerging corporates, business banking and rural lending.



His candidature, however, runs up against RBI rules that cap the continuous tenure of a managing director, CEO or whole-time director at a private bank at 15 years. Bharucha would reach that ceiling in June 2029.

Bagchi, 55, brings broad experience across both retail and wholesale financial services after more than three decades with the ICICI Group. During his career, he has handled retail banking, MSME, rural banking, corporate banking, treasury and markets, credit policy, digital channels and data analytics. He has also headed ICICI Securities and, since 2023, has led ICICI Prudential Life Insurance. His experience spans lending, liabilities, capital markets and insurance—a breadth that few senior bankers in the system possess and one that is particularly relevant given the scale and complexity of HDFC Bank.

Balasubramanian brings a more corporate and institutional banking-heavy profile, along with familiarity with HDFC Bank itself where he spent a brief period in 2016-17. He headed corporate banking and the government business, giving him familiarity with the lender’s internal culture and senior management. As Citi India CEO and head of banking for the Indian subcontinent, he oversees the US lender’s operations across the region.

Policy Doctor: Health Insurance Guide



KAPIL MEHTA
CO-FOUNDER, SECURENOW

My mother, 72 years old, is covered under a family floater plan, with a sum insured of ₹6 lakh (without any co-payment clause). My father, 83, has a senior citizen health insurance policy, with a sum insured of ₹5 lakh and 30% co-pay. Both have been diagnosed with hypertension. Since the current sums insured for both are low, I want to buy a higher cover of at least ₹10 lakh. Please suggest individual/floater plans for my parents.
—Kumardip Sen, Kolkata

I agree that you should increase your parents’ sums insured. However, you must continue to renew the existing policies, too, even though the cover is low; you can boost the overall protection through top-up plans. It appears that your parents’ hypertension was diagnosed after their insurance was bought, so it will not be considered as a pre-existing health condition. If you try to port

your base plan to another insurer, the premiums might go up because of the existing hypertension. Top-up plans complement base plans well and are cost-effective. You should look at top-up covers of ₹10-20 lakh for your parents. The top-ups that you buy separately for each parent, should have a deductible of ₹5 lakh for your mother and ₹3 lakh for your father. The way this combination of base and top-up will work is that, in the case of a hospitalisation claim, the first ₹5 lakh in your mother’s case and ₹3.5 lakh in your father’s (because of the co-pay) case will be paid for by your base plan. Any additional costs will be funded by the top-up insurance policy. These covers could exclude hypertension-related issues for the initial 2-3 years, but your base plan will cover these costs. Do note, however, that top-up options for your father may be limited because of his age.

Have a health insurance query? Write to us at etwealth@timesofindia.com

Tech Picks

CHANDAN TAPARIA,
Head - Derivatives & Technical

Motilal Oswal
Fin Services

TD POWER

Stock has broken out of consolidation into all-time-high territory, indicating strong bullish momentum.

LAST CLOSE> ₹804 STOP LOSS> ₹780

BUY
TARGET
₹850

WABAG

Stock’s cup-and-handle breakout is sustaining above breakout zone, signalling continued buying interest.

LAST CLOSE> ₹2,277 STOP LOSS> ₹2,200

BUY
TARGET
₹2,420

GRANULES

Stock is giving a rounding-bottom breakout near its all-time high, indicating strong bullish momentum.

LAST CLOSE> ₹909 STOP LOSS> ₹880

BUY
TARGET
₹960

Is Senior Living An Option for You?

►► From ET Markets Page 1

The accommodation includes studio apartments, 1-, 2-, 3-BHK flats and independent villas or cottages, available in both ownership and rental or lease models. While the older projects have an entry price of around ₹40 lakh for their 1/2-BHK flats, newer projects can range from ₹40 lakh to around ₹10 crore (luxury segment).

Besides the purchase price, other upfront costs include security deposit, advance management fee, or a medical deposit. Then there are recurring monthly maintenance charges, along with variable fees, depending on the services utilised. In addition to housekeeping and maintenance,

most campuses have extensive recreational facilities, personalised activities, community events, festivals, and get-togethers. They also provide a 24-hour nursing attendant or physiotherapist, an ambulance with a driver, and a doctor on call in case of an emergency.

Retirement homes are equipped to cater to specific senior needs, which justifies the higher upfront costs and recurring charges compared to a regular housing society, but money is a big concern for retirees.

Retirement corpus: It’s best not to deplete your retirement corpus or sell a self-occupied property to fund a senior living purchase.

Govt Eyes Supply Chain Matchmaking at Semicon 2026

PERFECTING THE CHEMISTRY Next week's summit to feature curated roundtables with Asian, US and EU chip firms

Subhayan Chakraborty

New Delhi: The government has proposed that technologically advanced countries participating in the upcoming Semicon India 2026 summit work with India to develop industrial linkages across semiconductor materials, components, equipment and intellectual property (IP), officials told ET.

As part of the exercise, the Centre has identified Indian equipment, sub-assembly and component makers that will hold roundtable discussions with their counterparts from the US, Japan, Singapore, South Korea, Malaysia and Europe at the three-day summit in New Delhi beginning September 17, they said.

The European roundtable will include companies from Sweden, Netherlands, Germany and Italy.

"Indian firms have been identified for attending the curated roundtables, and are being supported to forge partnerships with foreign entities from partner countries who are stalwarts in their category within semi-

conductors," one official said. "The idea is to accelerate matchmaking among interested parties."

Each participating nation excels in specific areas of the global chip value chain.

Malaysia holds about 30% of the global market share in Out-sourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT), while South Korea is a leader in the production of memory chips.

Japan holds a significant share of the global upstream semiconductor materials production line,

including manufacturing of light-sensitive chemicals called photoresists, high-purity etching gases and wafer-cleaning and coating equipment. Similarly, the US leads in fabless chip design and core semiconductor IP.

"There is a lot of potential for Indian firms to enter the global supply chain in a strategic manner. To boost this, the summit will also see mentorship. Those Indian companies with experience of doing business with companies from another specific country, whether they have a joint venture or simply a sourcing agreement, will have other Indian companies looking to access that economy," the official said.

The roundtables have been orga-

nised in response to interest from the industry, he said, adding that the Centre expects the incentives being offered for establishing a domestic manufacturing ecosystem to draw the highest number of investment applications under the recently notified India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) 2.0 scheme.

Under ISM 2.0, the government is providing up to 30% of eligible capital expenditure as support to companies setting up facilities to manufacture semiconductor raw materials like wafers, substrates, chemicals and glasses, as well as for firms installing units for manufacturing or assembling of equipment, sub-assemblies and components.



Shifting from 'silica to silicon' de-risks India's role and elevates the nation from an assembly market to a critical tech sovereign

Under ISM 2.0, the government is providing up to 30% of eligible capital expenditure as support to companies setting up facilities to manufacture semiconductor raw materials like wafers, substrates, chemicals and glasses, as well as for firms installing units for manufacturing or assembling of equipment, sub-assemblies and components.

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Tweet OF THE DAY



On the way to killing all of us, AI will likely kill some of us. In that case, who's liable?

Tech Buzz

OpenAI Agents Hit RubyGems First: Experts

NEW YORK: AI agents being tested by OpenAI attacked software service RubyGems two months before they hacked open-source platform Hugging Face, researchers said, the latest revelation of cyberattacks that have spooked the public and spurred calls for tighter regulation. Many incidents where AI agents from OpenAI and rival Anthropic have hacked have heightened concerns over the increasing capacity of AI models and developers' ability to contain them. The latest revelation also comes as growing numbers of US lawmakers call for new rules to govern AI systems after dire warnings from two Anthropic researchers. AI agents uploaded malicious packages to RubyGems on May 11, according to researchers who posted their findings online. — Reuters

\$50billion
Valuation AI startup Discovery Loop is seeking in new fundraising. — Reuters

DeepMind AI Expert Warns of Rising Risks

NEW DELHI: New concerns over the pace of artificial intelligence development intensified after Google DeepMind researcher Josh Engels left the company's AGI safety team to join independent AI-evaluation group METR, saying he believes there is a "terrifying chance" that AI systems could cause immense harm within the next five years. Engels said in a post on X that he left DeepMind three weeks ago despite enjoying his work. He warned that recursive self-improvement (RSI), in which AI systems help build increasingly capable successors, could become dangerous for humanity if alignment does not keep pace with capability gains. — Agencies

Cosmic Chemistry Pulls Indian Spacetechs into Japanese Orbit

BEYOND WESTERN ORBIT Japanese cos aggressively scout & fund India's private space ecosystem

Puran Choudhary

Bengaluru: Japan is emerging as a new market for India's spacetechnology startups as geopolitical shifts push countries to build more sovereign space capabilities and diversify technology and supply-chain.

Startups such as Digantara Industries, Bellatrix Aerospace, Xovian Aerospace, SatNxt and Manastu Space are seeing growing interest from Japanese customers and partners as the country looks to grow its own space and defence capabilities.

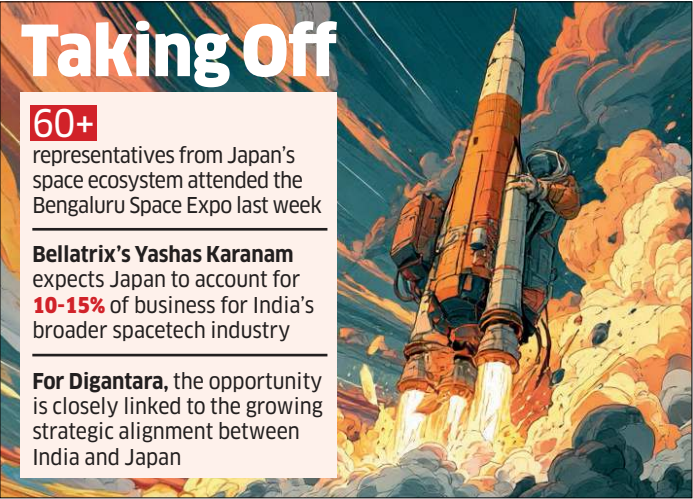
More than 60 representatives from Japan's space ecosystem attended the Bengaluru Space Expo last week, according to industry executives, making it one of the larger international delegations at the event.

Japanese companies were scouting Indian startups across launch, propulsion, Earth observation, space situational awareness and ground infrastructure, founders told ET.

For some, the interest has already translated into business. Bellatrix, which makes satellite propulsion systems, is working with two Japanese companies under commercial contracts and is currently manufacturing products for them. The startup has also partnered with Japanese space debris firm Astroscale.

IN THE SPOTLIGHT

Digantara Industries, Bellatrix, Xovian Aerospace, SatNxt and Manastu Space are seeing growing interest from Japanese customers



60+ representatives from Japan's space ecosystem attended the Bengaluru Space Expo last week

Bellatrix's Yashas Karanam expects Japan to account for **10-15%** of business for India's broader spacetechnology industry

For Digantara, the opportunity is closely linked to the growing strategic alignment between India and Japan

"We are not doing much of pilots now. Both the relationships are under commercial contracts, and we are currently in the manufacturing phase," Bellatrix cofounder Yashas Karanam told ET.

Karanam expects Japan to eventually account for 10-15% of the business for India's broader spacetechnology industry, although the US and Europe will remain larger markets.

For Reliance-backed Digantara, the opportunity is closely linked to

the growing strategic alignment between India and Japan.

"Japan is becoming an important market for us, and a lot of that comes from the strength of the India-Japan relationship itself. That is starting to translate into industry as well," Digantara founder and CEO Anirudh Sharma said. Japan is also investing seriously in building its defence and industrial capacity. "Put those things together, and it becomes a very interesting market for companies like Digantara," Sharma said. Digantara has also started engaging with Japanese stakeholders.

JAPAN'S PARTNERSHIP WITH INDIA

Other Indian startups have also established links with Japan. Skyroot Aerospace and Agnikul Cosmos have identified Japan as a target market, while Dhruva Space has a commercial partnership with Tokyo-based Infostellar for satellite ground infrastructure. Manastu Space, which develops green satellite propulsion systems, is also focusing on Japan and is exploring partnerships there, including work with Japanese company Takasago Fluidic Systems. SatNxt has analysed more than 230 Indian spacetechnology companies for Japanese clients seeking to understand the ecosystem and identify potential partners, founder Vivek Prasad said.

Tech Trotter

Oracle Pencils \$700m More for Rejig & Job Cuts

Oracle increased the scale of its planned job cuts while the company grapples with a cash crunch tied to development of large-scale data centres for artificial intelligence work.

The company also disclosed a new share trading programme for chairman Larry Ellison, who owns about 40% of Oracle's stock. The plan, which was adopted on June 22, permits Ellison to sell 50 million shares through October 24, the company said in a regulatory filing. The shares closed June 22 at \$175.07 — a value of \$8.75 billion for 50 million shares — and have declined 16% since then through Friday's close.

Ellison has been a major financial backer of his son David's takeover last year of Paramount Global and a \$110 billion bid by David Ellison's Paramount Skydance for Warner Bros. Discovery. The cost of Oracle's job cuts is now estimated at about \$2.8 billion. — Bloomberg

New Ecomm Rules Loom Large Over Online Retail's Wild West

What changes for Amazon, Flipkart & consumers as norms kick in?

ET EXPLAINER

Pranav Mukul

New Delhi: With an aim to strengthen consumer protection while creating a "transparent and balanced regulatory framework" for e-commerce, the government on September 10 announced new e-commerce rules effective from January 1, 2027. Industry executives said these rules could change how e-commerce companies such as Amazon and Flipkart market product discounts but the implementation schedule means that no new changes will be introduced in the upcoming festive season mega sales for this year.

WHAT WILL CHANGE ABOUT DISCOUNTS?

According to the new rules announced by the consumer affairs ministry, when an e-commerce platform or seller announces a price reduction, it will have to show both the reduced price and the prior price. Crucially, the prior price will mean the



lowest price at which the product was offered during the 30 days before the discount was announced.

This could change how festive sales are marketed in future years. Amazon, Flipkart and other e-commerce platforms typically rely heavily on headline discounts during the September-November shopping season. The new rule will make it harder for sellers to advertise a large percentage discount by comparing the sale price with an artificially high reference price if the product was available more cheaply during the preceding 30 days.

WILL ECOMMERCE PLATFORMS HAVE TO CHANGE THEIR SEARCH RESULTS?

The rules say e-commerce entities cannot manipulate search results in a way that misleads users or adversely affects the relevance of results to their search query. Sponsored listings will also have to be identified through "clear and prominent disclosures". For platforms, this could have implications for the way paid visibility and organic search results are presented to shoppers. E-commerce companies increasingly generate revenue from advertising and sponsored product placements, making the distinction between paid and organic visibility important.

FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO www.economictimes.com

Mid-tier VCs Rewrite Playbooks to Chase India's Deeptech Bets

Space & chips in focus as VCs trade financial models for scientific expertise

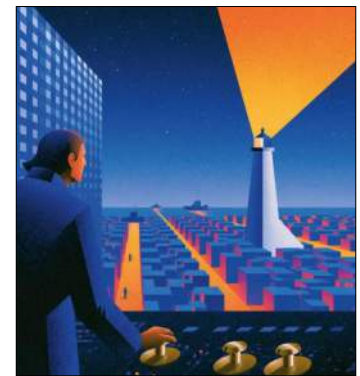
Disha Acharya & Nikhil Patwardhan

Bengaluru: Established mid-tier venture capital (VC) firms are stepping up their deeptech investments in India, but assessing businesses built on complex science and engineering requires expertise beyond their traditional generalist playbooks.

Antler, Bertelsmann India Investments (BII), Jungle Ventures, Bessemer Venture Partners and Kae Capital are hiring domain specialists, tapping global advisers and earmarking capital for the sector.

Antler is evaluating seven to eight deeptech startups every month and Bertelsmann India Investments (BII) is eyeing one to two deals across climate tech, defence tech and semiconductors in India.

So far in calendar year (CY) 2026, de-



eptech startups have already attracted \$574 million across 61 funding deals, which is almost 84% of the \$679 million raised in all of CY25 across 94 deals, according to Venture Intelligence data shared with ET. CY26 data includes large rounds like satellite

imaging startup Pixxel's \$100 million funding and Skyroot's \$60 million round which made it India's first space tech unicorn.

Early-stage Indian VC firm Antler is evaluating seven to eight deeptech startups every month and Bertelsmann India Investments (BII) is eyeing one to two deeptech deals across climate tech, defence tech and semiconductors in India. "We used to evaluate maybe one deeptech company seriously each month. Now, it is seven to eight a month," said Nitin Sharma, founding partner, Antler.

"The big catalysts are talent quality, geopolitics, the sovereign-India thesis, and the capital support from the RDI (Research, Development and Innovation) initiatives. These are making most VCs pay attention."

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India can be a Sandbox for Ethical, Affordable AI, says WBG's Zhang

Says continuous re-skilling for youth, women vital to secure India's edge

Dia Rekhi

Chennai: India can be a testbed for AI deployment at a crucial time for the international community when increased AI adoption could help address the challenge of job creation which is likely to be one of the foremost concerns for countries in the next decade, World Bank managing director and chief administrative officer Wencai Zhang told ET.

He was on a visit to Chennai last week to commemorate 25 years of the finan-

GRIT & GREATNESS: Inside the minds of the ETSA winners rewriting India's startup playbook

Varaha Digging in as India's Carbon Credit Mkt Takes Deep Root

'SOCIAL ENTERPRISE' champ primes for exponential growth as India's compliance carbon mkt ignites



Ayanti Bera

Bengaluru: Gurugram-based Varaha, which works with small-holder farmers on carbon removal projects, sees growing opportunity in India's nascent carbon market, even as the demand for its carbon credits currently comes from global companies.

Varaha was named the winner of the Social Enterprise category at The Economic Times Startup Awards 2026. The company stood out for the elite jury for its focus on addressing an emerging environmental concern and its ability to create a model that delivers measurable outcomes while building a profitable business.

Varaha operates primarily in the carbon removal segment, which involves methods that remove carbon dioxide from the atmosphere and trap it in soil or other forms. This is distinct from traditional carbon reduction projects such as renewable energy and electric vehicles, where the objective is to prevent emissions that would otherwise have occurred.

Founded in 2022 by Madhur Jain, Ankita Garg, Vishal Kuchanur, the company has raised \$55 million across multiple funding rounds from investors such as WestBridge Capital, RTP Global, and Omnivore, according to Tracxn. It competes with startups such as Lightspeed-backed Mitti Labs, which works with rice farmers to reduce methane emissions, and Alt Carbon, which focuses on carbon removal through enhanced rock weathering.

Varaha currently works with around 2.3 lakh smallholder farmers across India, Nepal, Bangladesh, Bhutan, and Ivory Coast, and has realised more than \$15 million in revenue over the last two financial years, cofounder and CEO Madhur Jain told ET. He added that the company has made cumulative payments of more than \$7 million to communities across its projects and interventions.

"Last year alone, around \$8 billion worth of carbon removals were contracted. So a sector that is so new saw a huge spurt in growth over the last year itself. This is because it's easy to track, monitor and measure the impact," Jain said.



We foresee demand picking up in the Indian market somewhere at the end of this year or like early next year, given the government has now fixed very specific targets for the major emitters

Varaha has had more than 700,000 carbon credits issued to date, while total credits sold stand at several million tonnes.

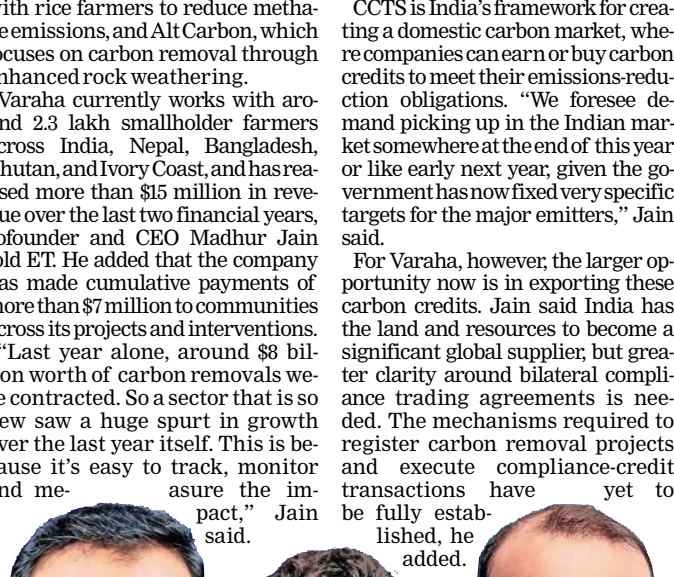
Its projects span multiple types of carbon removal, including soil carbon, agroforestry, biochar and enhanced rock weathering. For instance, biochar helps remove carbon by converting agricultural biomass into a stable form of carbon and storing it in soil, rather than allowing the biomass to decompose or be burnt and release carbon dioxide. It can remain in soil for around 1,200 years, offering long-term carbon storage.

The company signs long-term off-take agreements with global companies, such as Google, Microsoft, Lufthansa and JP Morgan. Such contracts allow buyers to lock in future supply as they expect carbon-credit prices to rise. Typically, prices are determined through bilateral agreements rather than a standard market rate.

The company now expects India's domestic carbon market to become more meaningful. The Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS) went live on April 1, with emissions targets initially covering sectors such as petrochemicals, textiles, cement, steel and fertilisers.

CCTS is India's framework for creating a domestic carbon market, where companies can earn or buy carbon credits to meet their emissions-reduction obligations. "We foresee demand picking up in the Indian market somewhere at the end of this year or like early next year, given the government has now fixed very specific targets for the major emitters," Jain said.

For Varaha, however, the larger opportunity now is in exporting these carbon credits. Jain said India has the land and resources to become a significant global supplier, but greater clarity around bilateral compliance trading agreements is needed. The mechanisms required to register carbon removal projects and execute compliance-credit transactions have yet to be fully established, he added.



Hyundai to Roll Out Driver-assist in 2029

Seoul: Hyundai Motor Group will launch vehicles equipped with its proprietary driver-assistance software in late 2029, two years later than planned, turning to Nvidia in the interim to accelerate deployment. The South Korean automaker will partner with the US chipmaker to

roll out advanced driver-assistance systems (ADAS), known as Level 2+ and Level 2++, in 2028, a Hyundai executive said. The shift underscores the challenges Hyundai faces in developing automated driving software in-house, a project originally slated for a late-2027 debut. — Reuters

India can be a Sandbox for Ethical, Affordable AI, says WBG's Zhang

Says continuous re-skilling for youth, women vital to secure India's edge

WENCAI ZHANG
MD, World Bank Group

Ultimately, India's AI trajectory will depend on its ability to translate strong digital public infrastructure into scalable, inclusive public-sector solutions

cial institution's Global Business Centre (GBC) in the city. "India can be a testbed for responsible and affordable AI deployment," Zhang said. "Ultimately, India's AI trajectory will depend on its ability to translate strong digital public infrastructure into scalable, inclusive public-sector solutions. Embedding AI into critical sectors such as

financial inclusion, healthcare, agriculture, and governance can ensure that innovation delivers measurable benefits for both citizens and the broader economy."

Zhang also said that India's talent has a competitive edge in the AI era but warned that a truly future-ready economy requires a broad foundation of problem-solving skills, digital literacy, and continuous re-skilling, especially for youth and women. He said the World Bank's Chennai GBC has benefited from Indian talent. The Chennai GBC was started in 2001 with 70 people and has grown since to more than 1700 people, making it the largest office for the World Bank Group outside of its headquarters in Washington DC by headcount.

FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO www.economictimes.com

Vi Eyes ₹35,000-crore Loan to Fund Next Decade's Capex

Telco assembling a consortium of 8-10 lenders; SBI likely to take ₹7,000 cr exposure

Joel Rebello & Himanshi Lohchab

Mumbai: Vodafone Idea (Vi) is stitching together a consortium of 8-10 lenders to finance a ₹35,000-crore, 10-year term loan as the Aditya Birla Group-backed mobile operator prepares to raise funds for capital expenditure in the next decade.

The nation's largest bank, State Bank of India (SBI), has approved a proposal to take about 20% of the exposure (likely at ₹7,000 crore). The rest of the loan will be divided among other public and private sector lenders, with a minimum of ₹1,500 crore per creditor, people familiar with the details said.

"SBI has done an internal assessment, which came to about ₹35,000 crore of loans needed. Now, it is up to the company to get other lenders on board. The company will totally need ₹60,000 crore to upgrade its services, which means some of it will have to come from internal accruals or equity infusion later," said a person familiar with the details.

SBI has set certain conditions for this loan, which say that any short-fall in investments above the bank loan amount during this period will be managed by the company. Kumar Mangalam Birla, who came back as chairman of Vi in May 2026, must remain the chairman of the company for the tenure of the loan, people

Funding Network

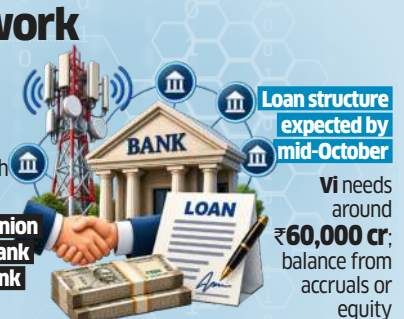
LOAN TO SPAN 10 YEARS

SBI could take up 20% of the exposure

NaBFID likely 2nd-largest lender at about ₹4,000 cr

Other lenders to contribute at least ₹1,500 cr each

PNB, Canara Bank, BoB, Union Bank, ICICI Bank and HDFC Bank in talks



familiar with the details said. "SBI would have an oversight over the cash flows of the company, and all funds will be routed to their accounts. There is also a clause that the Aditya Birla Group has to maintain its equity stake in the company after converting its warrants and rights. There is also a comfort guarantee from a group company, which is part of the conditions," said a second person aware of the details. SBI did not reply to an email seeking comment.

EQUITY OWNERSHIP

The Aditya Birla Group and associated companies own about 6.64% of the company currently and are the third-largest shareholder behind the Government of India (GoI) and UK-based Vodafone

(19%). The government currently owns 49% of the telco after converting some dues into equity.

Bankers wanted comfort from the group that Vi and its creditors will not be left to fend for themselves if things don't pan out as planned.

"Kumar Birla had earlier quit the Vi board in 2021 when the company was burdened by high government outgoes and falling revenues. He came back as chairman in May this year as things improved. Banks want to make sure that they are not left in a lurch if things don't work out," said the second person cited above. Vi did not reply to an email seeking comment.

Among the other prominent lenders in the consortium is the National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development (NaB-

FID), which is likely to be the second largest lender in the consortium with about ₹4000 crore exposure. NaBFID did not reply to an email seeking comment.

"Other large public sector banks like Punjab National Bank, Canara Bank, Bank of Baroda and Union Bank of India are also in touch with the company and are likely to be on board now that SBI has joined. Large private sector banks like ICICI and HDFC are also in touch. This is a large loan and will need 8-10 lenders. The contours of the loan will be ready by the middle of October," said a third person aware of the details.

IMPROVING PROSPECTS

Lenders are looking favourably at Vi, especially after the government slashed the company's adjusted gross revenue (AGR) payables by 27% to ₹64,046 crore late April.

Vi narrowed its underlying consolidated net loss to ₹5,358 crore in the June quarter from ₹6,611 crore in the same period last year. It was also the first full quarter of positive net subscriber additions since the Vodafone-Idea merger in 2019.

Vi's customer base rose to 193.1 million as of June-end from 192.8 million in the previous quarter. Its average revenue per user (ARPU) grew 10.2%, the highest in the industry.

Trai Moves to Keep Legit AI Calls Off Spam List

Cos using automated calling systems will have to declare such calls to their telecom providers

Himanshi Lohchab & Kiran Rathee

Mumbai | New Delhi: The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (Trai) is set to introduce measures to ensure that legitimate artificial intelligence (AI) business calls are not blocked as spam by telecom operators to support the emerging voice AI industry.

Under amendments being finalised to the Telecom Commercial Communications Customer Preference Regulations (TCCPR), businesses using automated calling systems will be required to declare such calls to their telecom service providers.

This will allow operators to identify legitimate automated traffic within their networks and prevent their internal anti-spam sys-



FALSE ALARMS

Regulator aims to prevent operators' internal systems from wrongfully flagging legitimate automated calls as spam

tems from incorrectly flagging such calls as spam. Trai is set to notify the changes this week, people aware of the details told ET.

Businesses as well as registered telemarketers must only send commercial communication through allocated numbering series, and any use of a 10-digit number will draw action for spreading spam.

"The license does not prohibit use of AI-solutions to send marke-

ting or other commercial communications. However, the accountability of the numbering resources lies with the person against whom the number has been allocated. Any misuse will draw penal action," an official said.

"Businesses using voice AI found that their genuine transactional calls, such as credit card payment reminders and other customer notifications, can be blocked or suppressed when telecom net-

works identify their automated calling patterns as spam," said the founder of a voice AI startup. "Therefore, we reached out to Trai, and they acknowledged that the emerging sector needs a new oversight mechanism."

The proposed measures come as India's voice AI market is expanding rapidly, with startups and enterprises deploying conversational AI for sales, customer support, financial services and collections.

According to venture capital firm Peak XV, voice AI is set to become India's first \$1 billion enterprise AI category over the next two years. Several players including ElevenLabs, Sarvam, Gnani.AI, Bolna AI, Squadstack, Navana AI, Ringg AI, Exotel, and Vobiz AI have shown tremendous growth in India's fast-growing voice AI space.

DEPUTY GOVERNOR ROHIT JAIN TO DISCUSS MATTER WITH BANK CHIEFS

Banks Seek RBI Nod to Use New Rules for Old Trade Mismatches

Unsettled trades touched nearly ₹1 lakh cr; lenders fear pending entries may trigger caution listing

Sugata Ghosh

Mumbai: Banks have sought regulatory clearance to close unsettled cross-border trades of clients which, over the years, have touched almost ₹1 lakh crore, with many unmatched entries pending for a decade.

They want Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) permission to use new regulations that will come into force from October 1, 2026, to close millions of unreconciled exports and imports—transactions where payments are overdue for goods that were shipped and funds were remitted, but the goods never landed.

The new rules allow banks to knock off old entries and sort out cases based on client declarations spelling out reasons for delays. Under the old, time-consuming regulations, banks must seek RBI's approval to close unresolved deals.

"Banks are unwilling to apply new regulations to close old matters (pending till September 30) unless RBI gives a go-ahead. To avoid being questioned later, banks are reluctant to use discretionary powers (under new regulations) without an RBI clearance. Banks want to resolve as many cases as possible by month-end to prevent exporters from being caution-listed for past unsettled trades," a senior banker told ET.

It's learnt that RBI deputy governor Rohit Jain has called a meeting with select bank CEOs this week to discuss the matter.

As per existing rules, caution-list-



ted exporters can undertake future exports only against advance payments or letters of credit, or payment guarantees, from overseas buyers' banks. While there's no RBI caution list for importers, they may face scrutiny from banks and the customs department for lapses. Under the new rules, the practice of caution-listing would end from October 1.

"But what about past transactions for which payments are overdue? If such cases are handled under old (i.e., existing) regulations, exporters could still be caution-listed," said the trade finance head of another bank.

According to Harshal Bhuta, partner at P. R. Bhuta & Co, which advises companies on FEMA and international tax, since the objective of new regulations is to liberalise and decentralise administration of trade regulations by empowering banks, RBI should consider allowing existing cases to also benefit from the new regime. "This would

benefit numerous cases of larger write-offs, set-off of export receivables against payables for different financial periods, delayed import payments, third-party payments without the requirement of a tripartite agreement, etc.," said Bhuta.

Banks can independently close outstanding trade payment entries up to ₹10 lakh per shipping bill or bill of entry without supporting documents. But outstandings are often higher, and even if RBI allows using new regulations to close old matters, many entries may remain unreconciled. There are cases where companies have shut down and officials can't be located to obtain a declaration.

Also, there were fly-by-night operators who remitted funds for non-existent cargo, cases where payments came from multiple banks and customers were unable to locate all documents; and mismatches due to change in address.

"The revised framework places greater responsibility on banks in monitoring and regularising export transactions. But, while this discretion may allow genuine delays and legacy issues to be addressed more efficiently, existing instances of non-compliance are not automatically regularised or extinguished," said Moin Ladha, partner at law firm Khaitan & Co.

Under the present framework, unresolved EDPMS entries may result in caution listing and associated restrictions, he said. EDPMS (Export Data Processing and Monitoring System) is a digital platform created by RBI to track export shipments and ensure that money received from overseas buyers is brought back. Similarly, IDPMS monitors the arrival of goods following foreign exchange outgo towards imports. Significantly, from October 1, the platforms would also capture records of export and import of services.

Patent Office Proposes Updating Pharma Filing Norms

Press Trust of India

New Delhi: The Indian Patent Office (IPO) has proposed updating guidelines for examination of pharmaceutical patent applications to improve the quality, consistency and uniformity of scrutiny, taking into account the evolving interpretation of laws by courts.

It has issued draft guidelines for examination of pharmaceutical applications for patent.

Pharmaceutical patenting in India is extremely important and a

sensitive issue because a bad patent can become a burden to society; good patents are essential for promoting innovation and technological development in the country.

To achieve these targets, the IPO is continuously upgrading its internal resources, revamping its internal work modules or its public interfaces. "In an attempt to bring in quality, consistency and uniformity, the office has introduced the guidelines for examination in certain key areas like pharmaceuticals," it said.

Further, many of the issues related to product patenting in the field of pharmaceuticals are now becoming clear through the decisions of courts.

"Therefore, there is a need to update guidelines for examination of pharmaceutical patents, incorporating the analysis of the courts, with the objective that the guidelines shall help in improvement of the examination standard and shall introduce harmonious practice amongst the technical officers of the system," according to the draft guidelines, dated September 4.

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